



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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BOUND VOLUMES of the Official Report (each with a comprehensive Index) are issued periodically during the Session. There is no fixed subscription rate, but prices will be quoted on each publication.

*Published by the Office of Chamber Reporting,
Parliament House, Accra.*

*Designed and Printed by Publishing Department,
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Opoku, Davis Ansah — NPP	<i>Mpraeso</i>
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Osei, Kennedy Nyarko — NPP	<i>Akim Swedru</i>
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Osei Mensah, Dapaah Elvis . — NPP	<i>Ahafo Ano South West</i>
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Quayson, James Gyakye, — NDC	<i>Assin North</i>

R

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Ricketts-Hagan, George Kweku — NDC	<i>Cape Coast South</i>

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W

William, Ntebe Ayo— NDC	<i>Tatale-Sanguli</i>
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Y

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Yibor, Isaac Awuku — NDC	<i>Domeabra Obom</i>

Z

Ziedeng, Bede Anwataazumo, Esq.— NDC	<i>Lawra</i>
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SUMMARY OF PARLIAMENTARY SEATS

	Men	Women	Seats
National Democratic Congress (NDC)	154	31	185
New Patriotic Party (NPP)	77	10	87
Independent	4	0	4
TOTAL	235	41	276

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3. Pearl Adzaho (Ms)*Assistant Director III*
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6. Lawrence Atoo *Executive Officer*

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7	Esther Donkor (Ms)	Senior Administrative Secretary
8	Joshua Otu Anim.....	Deputy Director (Administration)
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10	David Jawara Banye..(Contract).....	Assistant Intelligence Officer
11	Justice Dansu Novor.....(Contract).....	Personal Aide to Speaker
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20	Emmanuel Ladzagla.....	Senior Executive Officer
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5.	Abigail Maadey Amediku (Ms)(Contract).....	Stenographer Secretary
6.	Doreen Agyiri Asare (Ms).....(Contract).....	Stenographer Secretary
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9.		

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FINANCE, ECONOMICS & LEGAL COMMITTEES SUB-DIVISION

1. Akua Durowaa Owusu-Agyekum (Mrs) *Senior Principal Assistant Clerk*
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4. Edith Akrong, Esq.	Senior Assistant Clerk
5. Patience Kpotufe Mumcy (Ms)	Assistant Clerk II
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3. Saraphina Mapeira Pwamang (Ms)	Assistant Clerk II
4. Harriet Akua Akpene Hobenu (Ms)	Assistant Clerk II
5. Edith Zinayela Machieri (Ms)	Assistant Clerk II
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4. Eric Coleman	Assistant Clerk II
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11. Bennet Appiah Twumasi.....Assistant Clerk IV
12. Peace Krupskaya Bomansaan (Ms)Assistant Clerk IV
13. Rebecca Ofori (Ms)Stenographer Secretary

CORPORATE AND FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT SERVICES DIVISION

Gloria Akua Sarku Kumawu (Dr) (Mrs)Deputy Clerk

C&FMS Secretariat

1. Abraham Sarpong OwusuAssistant Research Officer II
2. Davidson Kwabena Techie-Menson.....Reporter II
3. Rejoice Adwoa Bukari (Ms)Stenographer Secretary

HUMAN RESOURCE, ADMINISTRATION AND GENERAL SERVICES SUB-DIVISION

Wilhelmina Sylvia Aidoo (Ms) Coordinating Director

Human Resource Department

1. Cornelia Puobi-Akumpule (Mrs)Director
2. Parvati W. Baidoo Opoku (Mrs)Deputy Director
3. Emefa Nadia Fiakpui (Ms)(Secondment).....Deputy Director
4. Maame Aba Baiden (Ms)Deputy Director
5. John Paul Tetteh Doku.....Deputy Director
6. Maame Afia Annoh-Dompreh (Mrs)Deputy Director
7. Harriet Agyei-Agyare (Ms)(Secondment).....Assistant Director I
8. Nancy Ohene-Safo (Ms)Human Resource Officer
9. Abigail Ofosu Okyere (Ms)Assistant Director IIA
10. Gloria Akoma Donkor (Ms)Human Resource Officer
11. Isaac Frimpong-Kusi-Siaw.....Assistant Human Resource Officer III
12. Yasmine Fatime Kamagate (Ms)Assistant Human Resource Officer III
13. Faiza Yakubu Abdul Aziz (Ms)Assistant Human Resource Officer III
14. Christiana Amankwah (Ms)Assistant Human Resource Officer III
15. Ruth Gyetuah (Ms)Senior Private Secretary
16. Gladys Asamani (Ms)Principal Executive Officer
17. Richard Kojo Boadi.....Clerical Officer
18. Richard Amoaning.....Clerical Officer
19. Bright Narh.....Clerical Officer

Administration Department

1. Sabrah Yahaya (Ms)Deputy Director
2. Ruby Yaa Korantiwaa Akae (Ms)(Secondment)Deputy Director
3. Edith Osman (Ms)Deputy Director
4. Emelia Dankwa Otoo (Mrs)Deputy Director
5. Christabel Gyamera-Tawiah (Ms)(Secondment)Assistant Director I
6. Linda Sedinam Amewu (Ms)Assistant Director IIA
7. Alberta Ofori (Ms)Assistant Director IIA
8. Anita Afi Agbavor (Ms)Assistant Director IIA

9. Gertrude Ofori Asare (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA
10. Dominic Adonye Ziemah	Assistant Director III
11. Alice Mirinda Coleman (Ms)	Assistant Director III
12. Ethel Naa Korley Tetteh (Ms)	Assistant Administrative Secretary IV
13. Irene Adubea (Ms)	Assistant Director III
14. Dorothy Yarquah (Ms)	Stenographer (Administration)
15. Doreen Yaa Nick Koffie (Ms)	Executive Officer

Psychology Unit

1. Patricia Benson Gaskin (Mrs)	Deputy Clinical Psychologist
2. Samuel Kwesi Adu Ansah Sasraku	Assistant Director III
3. Helena Agnes Hubert (Ms)	Clerical Officer

Gym Unit

1. Alex Yawson	Assistant Director III
2. George Yaw Gyamfi	Gym Attendant

Nutrition and Catering Services Department

1. Joseph Wilson-Tetteh	Consultant
2. Shirley Florence Tetteh (Ms)	Deputy Director
3. Jerry Adu Yirenkyi	Assistant Director III (Catering)
4. Florence Kesewaa Bedford (Mrs)	Chief Catering Officer
5. Justice Kwame Musah	Principal Catering Officer
6. Sarah Naakie Pinto (Ms)	Senior Catering Officer
7. Joyce Wahab (Ms)	Senior Catering Officer
8. Doris Ziedeng (Ms)	Senior Catering Officer
9. Esther Frimpong (Ms)	Senior Catering Officer
10. Constance Ayimah Otoo	Senior Catering Officer
11. Abigail Coffie (Ms)	Senior Catering Officer
12. Diana Afriyie Osei (Ms)	Senior Catering Officer
13. Doris Betsy Abokoma Clerk (Ms)	Senior Catering Officer
14. Solomon Kranpah	Senior Catering Officer
15. Esther Naa Adjeley Tetteh (Ms)	Senior Catering Officer
16. Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan	Catering Officer
17. Richard Osuman Adjartey	Assistant Catering Officer
18. Margaret Yost Adu (Mrs)	Assistant Catering Officer
19. Ruby Peterkin Yanzu (Mrs)	Assistant Catering Officer
20. Gifty Baziing (Ms)	Senior Cook
21. Felicia Dzebu (Ms)	Senior Cook
22. Felicia Oforiwa Nyampong (Ms)	Senior Cook
23. Obed Ofei Dawutey	Clerical Officer
24. Diana Djreh (Ms)	Kitchen Staff Supervisor
25. Justice Abbey	Staff Cook
26. Eugenia Aryee (Ms)	Staff Cook
27. Gertrude Akua Obo (Ms)	Staff Cook
28. Maame Abena Adabi Bawuah (Ms)	Senior Steward
29. Solomon Nartey	Senior Steward
30. Efua Parkoo (Ms)	Cook Assistant

Performance, Monitoring & Evaluation Department

1. Nicholas Francis Ayamga (Dr)	Director
2. Abdul-Jalilu Alhassan	(Secondment) Assistant Director I
3. Claris Efiya Quayson (Mrs)	Assistant Director IIA

4. Emma Adobea Opoku Afriyie (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA
5. Kwadwo Amoakoh Nsiah.....	Assistant Director II
6. Edmund Dzidefo Hehetror.....	Assistant Director III
7. Evans Elikem Adjei.....	Assistant Research Officer III
8. James Quartey Obinnyim.....	Assistant Director III

Transport, Logistics & Stores Department

1. John Kennedy Babo-Brown.....	Director
2. Awudu Adams Mumuni.....	Deputy Director
3. Felix Adom.....	Transport Officer III
4. Richard K. Amponsah-Odame.....	Chief Transport Assistant
5. Samuel Acheampong.....	Chief Transport Assistant
6. Ebenezer Tawiah.....	Chief Transport Assistant
7. Roland Ofori... ..	Chief Transport Assistant
8. Francis Crentsil... ..	Chief Transport Assistant
9. Foster Donkor.....	Chief Driver
10. Abdul Aziz Mohammed.....	Chief Driver
11. Samuel Kwame Aweregiya.....	Chief Driver
12. Isaac Dankwa.....	Chief Driver
13. Frederick Kumi.....	Chief Driver
14. Christian Thomas Sam.....	Chief Driver
15. Isaac Tekper Narh.....	Chief Driver
16. Richard Sam.....	Chief Driver
17. Gilbert Nana Nyarko.....	Chief Driver
18. Haruna Bashiru.....	Chief Driver
19. Prosper Bomansaan.....	Chief Driver
20. Julius Zigah.....	Chief Driver
21. Jacob Abunyewah.....	Chief Driver
22. Benjamin Sackey.....	Chief Driver
23. Maxwell Asamoah.....	Chief Driver
24. Sulev Ocran Sackey.....	Chief Driver
25. Wisdom Agornyo.....	Chief Driver
26. Frederick Ani-Gyebi.....	Chief Driver
27. Fred Dacoster Larbi.....	Chief Driver
28. Ohene Boadu.....	Chief Driver
29. Abdul-Rashid Musah Samari.....	Chief Driver
30. Samuel Essel.....	Chief Driver
31. Dennis Anyomi.....	Chief Driver
32. Daniel Kwame Adu.....	Assistant Chief Driver
33. Richard Dickson Ansrodja.....	Assistant Chief Driver
34. George Asante.....	Assistant Chief Driver
35. Albert, Kwaku Asiedu.....	Senior Driver
36. Obed Larbie Kwaku Lartey.....	Driver Gd. I
37. Daniel Attor.....	Driver Gd. I
38. Felix Dawutey.....	Driver Gd. I
39. Abass Seidu Bawa.....	Driver Gd. I
40. Patrick Asare Adofo.....	Driver Gd. I
41. Moshood Musah Abiola.....	Driver Gd. I
42. Kamal Saani.....	Driver Gd. I
43. Yaw Koduah.....	Driver Gd. I
44. Danladi Assah.....	Driver Gd. I

45. Sheriff Adamu Bawa.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. I
46. Jebuni Bayong Kala.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. II
47. Adinaan Dauda.....		Driver Gd. II
48. Mohammed Tahiru.....		Driver Gd. II
49. Richard Agyei.....		Driver Gd. II
50. Emmanuel Kwame Anyomi.....		Driver Gd. II
51. Richard Apreku.....		Driver Gd II
52. Akwasi Sarpong.....		Driver Gd II
53. Eric Kwasi Frimpong.....		Driver Gd. II
54. Elvis Kormla Dzah.....		Driver Gd. II
55. Toufic Salifu.....		Driver Gd. III
56. Osumanu Ahmed.....		Driver Gd. III
57. Daniel Doku.....		Driver Gd. III
58. Charles Achia.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
59. Fuseini Eyi-Mensah.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd III
60. Basit Chentiwuni Yussif.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
61. Eric Mensah.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
62. Enoch Arhinful.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
63. Stephen Atuahene.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
64. Raymond Kwadwo Sefah.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
65. Gideon Bissah.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
66. Francis Amedzor.....	Contract)	Driver Gd. III
67. Emmanuel Kofi Odoom.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
68. Mike Kpanawor.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
69. Amos Amoah.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
70. Stephen Owusu Boateng.....	(Contract)	Driver Gd. III
71. Florence Allotey-Pappoe (Ms).....		Assistant Materials Officer I
72. Fati Musah (Ms).....		Assistant Materials Officer III
73. Rukayatu Abass (Ms).....		Assistant Materials Officer III
74. Justice Akwasi Acquah.....		Assistant Materials Officer III
75. Frank Osei Obeng.....		Assistant Materials Officer III
76. Patience Abra Akubi (Ms)		Assistant Materials Officer III
77. Monica Amezah (Ms)		Assistant Materials Officer III
78. Sarah Naa Doduwa Ashong Agyekum (Mrs)		Assistant Materials Officer III

DEVELOPMENT SERVICES SUB-DIVISION

Department of Works

1. Saviour Sefakor Kpodo.....	Director
2. Fanny Appiawah Gyan (Ms)	Deputy Director
3. Nicholas Kpakpo-Brown.....	Deputy Director
4. Peter Tusah.....	Deputy Director
5. Daniel Francis Owusu Dapaah.....	Assistant Director II
6. Francois Awedana Kwogana.....	Assistant Director III
7. Samuel Wason-Quaicou.....	Principal Technical Officer (Plumbing)
8. John Akurante.....	Principal Technical Officer (Carpentry)
9. Emmanuel Kwaku Kemevor.....	Principal Technical Officer (Masonry)
10. Abdul-Rashid Iddrisu.....	Senior Technical Officer
11. Dauda Quao.....	Senior Technical Officer (Electrical)
12. Christian Osei Bonsu.....	Senior Technical Officer (Carpentry)

Department of Estates Management

1.	Kwasi Asare Darko.....	Director
2.	Jonas Yengnibeh.....	Deputy Director
3.	Emmanuel Kudah.....	Deputy Director
4.	Mary Janice Bawah (Ms)	Assistant Director II
5.	Nana Kwesi Kumi Asante.....	Assistant Director IIA
6.	Emmanuel Nyame-Owusu.....	Assistant Director III
7.	Kwame Wahab Kwakye.....	Assistant Director III
8.	Sampson Appiah.....	Chief Technical Officer (Plumbing)
9.	Francis Kwasi Akorley.....	Chief Technical Officer (Plumbing)
10.	Emmanuel Ackon.....	Chief Technical Officer (Carpentry)
11.	John Kedzi.....	Principal Technical Officer
12.	David Nii Saka Allotey.....	Senior Technical Officer
13.	Prince Kabenla Quaidoo.....	Technical Officer (Electrical)
14.	Benedicta Nai (Ms)	Higher Executive Officer
15.	Frederick Gyebi-Donkor.....	Artisan III

Facilities Management Department

1.	Alexander Kofi Eduful (Dr)	Director
2.	Evelyn Agurgo Balfour (Ms)	Deputy Director
3.	Gilbert Amartei Armah.....	Deputy Director
4.	Andrews Tei Pinto.....	Deputy Director
5.	Akosua Agyeiwaa Twumasi (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA (Administration)
6.	Joseph Kwesi Moore.....	Assistant Director III (Facilities Management)
7.	James Amoah.....	Assistant Director III (Air-condition)
8.	Loretta Adjoa Mensah (Ms).....	Assistant Administrative Secretary IV
9.	Tahiru Sarbogu.....	Assistant Director III
10.	Louis Azaare.....	Assistant Director III
11.	Eric Stone Adjei.....	Chief Technical Officer (Air-condition)
12.	Divine Akpah.....	Chief Technical Officer (Electrical)
13.	Michael Lanquaye Lamptey.....	Chief Technical Officer (Electrical)
14.	Michael Aleh.....	Principal Technical Officer (Plumbing)
15.	Gershon Dehar.....	Senior Technical Officer (Air-condition)
16.	Peter Kodzo Kpo.....	Technical Assistant I (Plumbing)
17.	Noah Amponsah.....	(Contract)..... Technical Assistant I (Electrical)
18.	Issaka Gariba.....	Chief Labourer
19.	Emmanuel Dodoo.....	Chief Labourer
20.	Moses Adjetey Adjei.....	Chief Labourer
21.	Stephen Adjei-Baffour.....	Chief Labourer
22.	Edward Ayurebome.....	Chief Labourer
23.	David Tetteh Ankamah.....	Chief Labourer
24.	Benjamin Appiah Nkansah.....	Chief Labourer
25.	Michael Dزامenu.....	Chief Cleaner
26.	Stella Boadi (Ms)	Chief Cleaner
27.	Theophilus Kwakye Ntow.....	Chief Gardener
28.	Helena Antwi (Ms)	Chief Cleaner
29.	Seth Obeng Ameyew.....	Chief Cleaner
30.	Emmanuel Annang Blebo.....	Chief Gardener
31.	Mutalib Mumin.....	Chief Labourer
32.	Maxwell Nii Saka Anege Akwei.....	Assistant Chief Cleaner

33. Dominic Nketia.....	Technical Assistant III (Tiler)
34. Daniel Kwame Amekudzi.....	Technical Assistant III (Carpentry)
35. Kow Acquandah Wallace.....	Technical Assistant III
36. Daniel Asamoah Darko.....	Technical Assistant III (Painting)
37. Daniel Odoi Yemoh.....	Principal Gardener
38. Solomon Donkoh.....	Messenger
39. Gladys Zienaa (Ms)	Senior Cleaner
40. Evans Nii Ankamah Tettey.....	Senior Labourer
41. Grace Kwakyewah (Ms)	Senior Cleaner
42. Patrick Akologo.....	Labourer

PARLIAMENTARY SECURITY SERVICES DIVISION

1. Lt. Col Samuel Kofi Ofori (Rtd)	Senior Principal Marshal
2. Wg Cdre. Frederick Bawa (Rtd)	Principal Marshal
3. Laurretta Ntummy (Ms).....	Assistant Director IIA
4. David Gyan.....	Assistant Marshal IV
5. Ivy Naa Dedei Hammond (Ms)	Assistant Director III
6. Amatus Baataapoug.....	Assistant Director III
7. Shiela Janet Noye (Ms)	Chief Administrative Assistant
8. Bright Tambo.....	Stenographer Secretary
9. Frederick Dodoo.....	Senior Executive Officer (Marshal)
10. Marian Serwah Kufuor (Ms).....	Executive Officer (Marshal)

Internal Security and Access Control Department

1. Grace Ntrivah Duah (Ms).....	Assistant Internal Security Officer III
2. David Gyan.....	Assistant Marshal IV
3. Robert Mbawine Azaare.....	Security Officer
4. Kojo Adongo.....	Security Officer
5. Daniel Acheampong.....	Security Officer
6. James Baba Atinga.....	Security Officer
7. John Frimpong-Manso.....	Security Officer
8. Daniel Delali Horvey.....	Assistant Security Officer
9. Christopher Dogbey.....	Assistant Security Officer
10. Martin Nwinesonga Naah.....	Assistant Security Officer
11. Albert Tewone Benyimse.....	Assistant Security Officer
12. Amin Mohammed.....	Assistant Security Officer
13. Issah Safianu.....	Assistant Security Officer
14. Sarni Asigri (Ex. Sgt.).....	Principal Security Guard
15. Michael Asak.....	Principal Security Guard
16. Athanasius Walter Baaku.....	Principal Security Guard
17. Nelson Kwadzo Dey.....	Principal Security Guard
18. Alexander Adjei.....	Principal Security Guard
19. Charles Poribo.....	Principal Security Guard
20. Justine Owusu Babatu,	Senior Security Guard I
21. Benjamin Boateng.....	Senior Security Guard I
22. David Darko.....	Senior Security Guard I
23. Benedict Wineyeya Dindego Asigri.....	Senior Security Guard I
24. Gabriel Atutra.....	Senior Security Guard I
25. William Anim.....	Senior Security Guard I

26. Kingsford Aidoo.....	Senior Security Guard I
27. Abudu Rahiman Sia.....	Senior Security Guard I
28. Patrick Sevor.....	Senior Security Guard II
29. Osuman Atinga.....	Senior Security Guard II
30. Henry Kpakpo Adotey.....	Senior Security Guard II
31. Francis Kaku.....	Senior Security Guard II
32. Jibrail Adnan.....	Senior Security Guard II
33. Byron Akuffo.....	Senior Security Guard II
34. Evans Avor.....	Senior Security Guard II
35. Ebenezer Duah.....	Senior Security Guard II
36. Peter Keney Adoteye.....	Senior Security Guard II
37. Russel Karikari Owusu.....	Senior Security Guard II
38. Eric Wiafe.....	Senior Security Guard II
39. Emmanuel Nana Mensah.....	Senior Security Guard II
40. Mohammed Mudassir Adjorlolo.....	Senior Security Guard II
41. Abukari Issahaku.....	Senior Security Guard II
42. George Mensah Nyarko.....	Senior Security Guard II
43. Abigail Debrah Dankwah (Ms).....	Senior Security Guard II
44. Freda Oppong (Ms).....	Security Guard
45. Ibrahim Shamwuna.....	Security Guard
46. Ametus Konbanpuo.....	Security Guard
47. Henry Jebuni.....	Security Guard
48. Silas Addai.....	Security Guard
49. Eric Kofi Mensah.....	Security Guard
50. David Tigapius Dinga.....	Assistant Security Guard

Ushers Unit

1. Joseph Kwakye.....	Chief Usher
2. Anthony Gator.....	Chief Usher
3. Sampson Kaba Kwotuah.....	Chief Usher
4. Maxwell Tetteh.....	Chief Usher
5. Dennis Tetteh.....	Chief Usher
6. Charlotte Sarfo (Ms).....	Usher Gd. I
7. Michael Akuamoah Boateng.....	Usher Gd. I

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT SERVICES

FINANCE & BUDGET SUB-DIVISION

1. Daniel Tamkibe Chirawura.....	Coordinating Director
2. Vida Afi Rose Tulasi (Ms).....	Chief Administrative Assistant

Department of Finance

1. Lisa Mambora Tia (Ms).....	Deputy Director
2. Richard Azumbil Kpelimnyanba.....	Finance Officer
3. David Kyetong Guun.....	Assistant Finance Officer II
4. Naana Smith Boyan (Mrs).....	Assistant Finance Officer III
5. Rex Bagbin.....	Assistant Finance Officer III
6. Derrick Kwabena Boateng.....	Assistant Finance Officer III
7. Bless Cudjoe (Ms).....	Assistant Finance Officer III

8. Anita Somiah (Ms).....Assistant Finance Officer III
9. Mary Abena Yeboah (Mrs).....Assistant Director III
10. Gifty Amuaki Amoatey (Ms).....Assistant Finance Officer III
11. Derrick Papa Yaw Owusu-Mensah.....Assistant Finance Officer III
12. Hayford Bekoe.....Principal Executive Officer
13. Harry Armah.....Principal Executive Officer

Department of Budget

1. William Kafui Assem, Esq. (Dr).....Director
2. Linda Agyemang Prempeh (Mrs).....Deputy Director
3. Esther Afia Amoah (Mrs).....Assistant Budget Officer I
4. Ugget Adjoa Kapuochieneh (Ms)Assistant Finance Officer III
5. Vishnu Osmond Buckle,Assistant Finance Officer III
6. Emmanuel Asare,Assistant Director III
7. Dorothy Gaisie (Ms)Private Secretary
8. Eugenia Nyamekye Quarshie (Ms).....Senior Executive Officer

COMPENSATION, BENEFITS & PENSIONS, ACCOUNTING & PROCUREMENT SERVICES SUB-DIVISION

- Karim Kuuri..Coordinating Director

Compensation, Benefits & Pensions Department

1. Albert Essuman.....Deputy Director
2. Richard Omenako Ansah.....Compensation & Pension Officer
3. Doris Dede Sika (Ms)Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer I
4. Kennedy Felasong.....Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer I
5. Herman Nana Osei Oppong Kyekyeku.....Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer III
6. Nana Yaw Adjei Adzinyo.....Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer III
7. Emma Nyantakyiwaa Addei (Ms).....Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer III
8. Joy Agyepong (Ms).....Assistant Compensation & Pension Officer III

Accounting Department

1. Alfred Agbesi Kpodzro.....Deputy Director
2. Priscilla Amuakwa-Mensah (Ms).....Accountant
3. Nasirudeen Adam Baduon.....Assistant Accounting Officer I
4. Jason Akotus.....Assistant Accounting Officer I
5. Elvis Poku Osei.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
6. Mark Agambire.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
7. Isaac Kwesi Glover.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
8. Nicholas Arthur.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
9. Salim Suhuyini Yussif.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
10. Gideon Kabutey Taffah.....Assistant Accounting Officer III
11. Patience Bagbin (Ms).....Principal Accounts Officer
12. Jennifer Atwiwaa Atsiako (Ms).....Senior Accounts Officer
13. Caleb Castro Dzeagu.....Senior Accounts Officer
14. Priscilla Adjeiwaa Appiah (Ms).....Senior Accounts Officer
15. Bernard Oheneba Karkari Addaie..Executive Officer

Procurement Department

1. Mohammed Nsiah... (Contract).....Director
2. Abdallah Adam Ahmed... Deputy Director
3. Frank Teye Ademan.....Deputy Director
4. Ebenezer Koomson.....Assistant Procurement Officer I
5. Maxwell Addo.. Assistant Procurement Officer II
6. Jeremiah Acquah Adjei.....Assistant Procurement Officer II
7. Josephine Selorm Goka (Ms).....Assistant Procurement Officer III
8. Ivy Ama Ewoenam Agbeke (Ms).....Assistant Procurement Officer III
9. Benedicta Betty Abbey (Ms).....Senior Procurement Assistant
10. Amanda Laryea (Ms) Stenographer
11. Frank Somiah Andoh.....Executive Officer
12. Emmanuel Ankomah.....Clerical Officer

INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SERVICES

Rosemary Arthur-Sarkodie (Mrs) Deputy Clerk

IMS Secretariat

1. Collins Asare.....Assistant Director III
2. Fusena Amirra Bashiru (Ms)Assistant Director III

PARLIAMENTARY RESEARCH CENTRE

1. Mohammed Hardi Nyagsi... Coordinating Director
2. Abraham Ibn Zackariah (Dr).....Principal Research Officer
3. Judy Benedicta Aikins (Ms)Principal Research Officer
4. Cephas Egbeforme... Principal Research Officer
5. Sandra Awuah (Ms)Senior Research Officer
6. Lord Michael Walierzumeh Baatuolkuu... Senior Research Officer
7. Kwame Boamah-Gyau... Senior Research Officer
8. Adjoa Abrefa-Tawiah (Ms)Assistant Research Officer I
9. Blessed Henry Insaidoo.. Assistant Research Officer I
10. Philip Marvin Coleman. Assistant Research Officer I
11. Abubakari Sadick Mohammed, PhD. Assistant Research Officer I
12. Prince Milonu. Assistant Research Officer I
13. Samuel Dukpo... Assistant Research Officer I
14. Abdulai Muftaw. Assistant Research Officer I
15. Ama Kesewaa Kwegyir Aggrey (Mrs)Assistant Research Officer I
16. Elizane Yaa Sika Adams (Mrs)Assistant Research Officer I
17. Sandra Kuffour (Ms)Assistant Research Officer I
18. Abigail Adei Kotey (Ms)Assistant Research Officer I
19. Alfred Benjamin Baiden... Assistant Director 11B
20. Kelvin Bondzie.. Assistant Research Officer III
21. Matilda Ofori Anto Kachire (Ms)Assistant Research Officer III
22. Nicholas Asubonteng.....Assistant Research Officer III
23. Kojo Anokye-Kwatutu Ocran.. Assistant Research Officer III
24. Gawsu Inusah.....Assistant Research Officer III
25. Abdul-Basit Abdulai, Assistant Research Officer III

26. Ruth Angviele Gaayuoni (Ms)Assistant Research Officer III
27. Priscilla Amanokor Ashong (Ms)Assistant Research Officer III
28. Priscilla Dwamena (Mrs)Stenographer Secretary

Data Management

1. John Nathaniel Boateng (Dr)Deputy Director
2. Isaac Kojo Appiah.....Data Management Officer
3. Michael Yakubu.Assistant Data Management Officer III
4. Clyde Henry Hyde...Assistant Data Management Officer III
5. Bernice Ama Dziedzorm Nuworsu (Ms)Assistant Data Management Officer III
6. Akosua Affumwaa Mensah (Ms)Assistant Data Management Officer III
7. Noel Kobla Hlordze.....Clerical Officer

Library

1. Jessica Adjeley Mensah (Ms)Librarian
2. Nana Tuhufo Quagraine.Deputy Librarian
3. Emmanuel Odai Laryea.Deputy Librarian
4. Emmanuel Nkansah Sefa.Deputy Librarian
5. Amanda Delali Fie (Ms)Deputy Librarian
6. Jemima Deles Yeboah (Ms).Senior Assistant Librarian
7. Edith Boaduwa Anto (Ms)Assistant Director IIA
8. Esther Esinam Degboe (Ms)Assistant Librarian III
9. Ruth Opoku Adusei (Ms)Assistant Librarian III
10. Michael Adjei Ablorh.....Assistant Librarian III
11. Dora Asaba Codjoe (Ms)Assistant Librarian III
12. Eric Badipan.....Principal Executive Officer
13. Antoinette Kanubala (Ms)Executive Officer

ICT & PUBLISHING SUB-DIVISION

- Christine Awah (Mrs)Coordinating Director

ICT Department

1. Leslie Nii Tei Addico..Director
2. Abdulai Issahaku Alhassan.Deputy Director
3. JohnBosco Aristotle Kanpogning Ansuura, Ing.Deputy Director
4. Daniel Mensah...Deputy Director
5. Ernest Taanu Berrick..Deputy Director
6. Maxwell Kwadjo Anyah..Deputy Director
7. Alberta Atsupi Govi (Mrs)Senior ICT Officer
8. Justice Ananabouh Yaro..Senior ICT Officer
9. Francis Kobina Essien..Senior ICT Officer
10. David Abebreseh Afriyie..Assistant ICT Officer I
11. Benjamin Abakah...Assistant ICT Officer I
12. Francis Adzayao.Assistant ICT Officer I
13. Samuel Lamptey.Assistant ICT Officer I
14. Felix Nii Aryeetey Armah...Assistant ICT Officer I

15. Issahaku Mohammed Mubarik..	Assistant ICT Officer I
16. Frederick Dongbee Yendaw....	Assistant ICT Officer I
17. Justice Kofy Kafui Odikro..	Assistant ICT Officer II
18. Kenneth Apodolla...	Assistant ICT Officer III
19. Mahami Sualisu.	Assistant ICT Officer III
20. Theophilus Kudjo Lumor.	Assistant ICT Officer III
21. Emmanuel Odei Kwakye.	Assistant ICT Officer III
22. Eric Yankah.	Assistant ICT Officer III
23. Fred Agyepong...	Assistant ICT Officer III
24. Fladys Tawiah (Ms)	Assistant ICT Officer III
25. Samuel Kyeremeh...	Assistant ICT Officer III
26. Seyram Akusika Dey (Ms)	Assistant ICT Officer III
27. Kelvin Kwamina Bandoh...	Assistant ICT Officer III
28. Roger Abendiba...	Assistant ICT Officer III
29. Gloria Owusu-Dwamena (Ms)	Private Secretary
30. Mark Nii Osa Mensah.....	Principal Technical Officer
31. Sellasie Ameyibor...	Principal Technical Officer
32. Mathias Korbi Ketorsugbor...	Principal Technical Officer
33. Frederick Yao Adzimahe...	Technical Officer
34. Jacob Annertey Abbey..	ICT Technician I
35. Kevin Nii Sackey Sackey.	ICT Technician
36. David Darko-Mensah.	Technical Officer
37. Roland Livingstone.	Technical Officer
38. Bright Amlasi..	Clerical Officer
39. Leopold Pinto..	Clerical Officer

Publishing Department

1. Anastasia Dzigbordi Thompson (Mrs)	Deputy Director
2. Pamela Aba Woode (Ms)	Deputy Director
3. Kenneth Kofi Asamoah.....	Deputy Director
4. Jude Laryea Ako-Nai...	Deputy Director
5. Linda Wendy Wordie (Ms)	Senior Publishing Officer
6. Francisca Gyasi Osei (Ms)	Senior Publishing Officer
7. Mariam Muntaka (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA
8. Millicent Akosua Birago (Ms)	Publishing Officer
9. Suraj Osman-Rasheed.....	Asst. Publishing Officer (Proofreading)
10. David Seyram Gadzekpo...	Assistant Publishing Officer
11. Justice Kese Opoku...	Assistant Publishing Officer III
12. Linda Darley Ayikoe Edoh (Mrs)	Assistant Publishing Officer III
13. Georgina Opoku Asare (Mrs)	Assistant Publishing Officer III
14. Theresa Ama Donkor (Ms)	Assistant Publishing Officer III
15. Samuel Darko...	Assistant Publishing Officer III
16. Irene Sakyiwa Owusu (Ms)	Private Secretary
17. Victor Adenyo.....	Chief Printer
18. Samuel Abrefa...	Chief Printer
19. Edwin Anyetei Ayeng...	Chief Administrative Assistant
20. Mary Lena Ghartey (Ms)	Chief Usher
21. Moses Addey...	Assistant Chief Printer
22. Gilbert Setsoafia...	Principal Executive Officer
23. Daniel Aryee.....	Senior Publishing Assistant

24. Gifty Abia Salakpi (Ms)Senior Publishing Assistant
25. Isaac Wesley Divine Azumah.....Senior Executive Officer
26. Nicholas Timothy Clerk.....Publishing Assistant I

PUBLIC AFFAIRS SUB-DIVISION

1. Kate Addo (Ms)Coordinating Director
2. Vida Delali Gavor (Ms)Assistant Director IIA
3. Thelma Anim Agyei (Ms).....Stenographer Secretary

Department of Parliamentary Broadcasting

1. Hilda Agyepong Asante Esq. (Mrs)Director
2. Peter Azameti Bamfo.....Deputy Director
3. Ekuba Bobolo Quayenortey (Mrs)Assistant Director I
4. Peace Abena F. Agbetsivi (Ms)..Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
5. Adwoa Odum Yankson (Ms)Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
6. Randy Sackey...Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
7. Julius Kwadwo Owusu Duah,Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
8. Derrick Tsekpo...Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
9. Matthew Amachie...Assistant Director III
10. Georgina Afia Kwarteng (Ms)Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
11. Stephen Ampofo.Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
12. Ibrahim Ansah.Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
13. Lemuel Godson Amamoo.Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
14. Clement Gyetteh Sam.Public Relations Officer (Sign Language Interpreter)
15. Georgina Joemerley Tagoe (Ms)Public Relations Officer (Sign Language Interpreter)
16. Efua Buduwa Taylor (Ms)Public Relations Officer (Sign Language Interpreter)
17. Joseph K. D. Ocansey.Assistant Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
18. Daniel Danso Amponsah.Assistant Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
19. Godfred Nii Nikoi Kotey.Assistant Chief Technical Officer (Audio-visual)
20. Augustine Mumuni Bukari.....Technician II

Department of Public Engagement

1. Supt. Elizabeth Effia Tengey (Rtd.)Director
2. Sharon Nana Fosua Kinful (Mrs)Deputy Director
3. Valerie Naa Lamiokor Boye (Ms)Deputy Director
4. Yvonne Delimini Yelibora (Mrs)(Contract).....Senior Public Affairs Officer
5. Nelly Akweley Abbey (Ms)Public Affairs Officer
6. Ahmed Mustapha...Public Affairs Officer
7. Bridget Quao (Ms)Public Affairs Officer
8. Ruby Odoiflorakor Ocquaye (Ms)Public Affairs Officer
9. Ewurasi Otuwaa Wobil (Ms)Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
10. Enock Adomah.Assistant Director III
11. Karimu Seidu Bogobiri.Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
12. Richella Akweley Addo (Ms)Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
13. Melissa Yaa Serwaah Duah (Ms)Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
14. Courage Toukuman Abdulai...Assistant Public Affairs Officer III

15. Matilda Danquah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
16. Domina Dedo Mate-Kole (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
17. Lady Asomaniwaa Sakyi (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
18. Faustina Mensah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
19. Rebecca Christiana Hutchful (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
20. Anita Lawerh Ocansey (Ms)	Stenographer Secretary

Department of Media Relations

1. David Sebastian Damoah, Esq.	Director
2. Lawrence Kwarteng-Ashia, (Dr)	Deputy Director
3. Sonnomma Abdul-Aziz Kaayora...	Senior Public Affairs Officer
4. Sulemana Sadat Alhassan.	Senior Public Affairs Officer
5. Obed Appiah.	Public Affairs Officer
6. Nana Agyeman Birikorang...	Public Affairs Officer
7. Patricia Agyarewaa Boateng (Ms)	Assistant Director III
8. Simon Kanubala Andrah..	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
9. Bernard Kotey Hammond...	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
10. Yesmeen Abubakar Tetteh...	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
11. Abigail Lily Dotse (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
12. Nana Adwoa Abrefi Gyamoh (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
13. Edward Nana Afriyie Glover...	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
14. Gloria Borley (Ms)	Stenographer Secretary
15. Jubal Edinam Gadzekpo...	Clerical Officer

Parliamentary Visitors Centre

1. Margaret Donkor (Ms)	Acting Head
2. Ibrahim Abu-Agyeman...	Assistant Director IIA
3. Mavis Ama Adjei (Ms)	Assistant Director IIA
4. Ruby Naa-Dei Ghansah (Mrs)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
5. Sarah Akuvi Ahumah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
6. Rita Adu-Oppong (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
7. Salomey Mawuli Abor (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
8. Bless Ruth Adjetey (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
9. Doris Yemoley Mensah (Ms)	Assistant Public Affairs Officer III
10. Rahmatu Abdulai (Ms)	Senior Executive Officer
11. Maria Agbenu-Ntow (Ms)	Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
12. Esther Mingle (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
13. Millicent Dede Opata (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
14. Esther Adda (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
15. Elizabeth Kutorwu (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
16. Bernice Asabea Asante (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
17. Francisca Tuffour (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
18. Gifty Atoo (Ms)	Assistant Chief Telephonist/Receptionist
19. Nathaniel Songojage	Clerical Officer
20. Edem Atinaval Appekey (Ms)	Clerical Officer

ANCILLIARY STAFF

PARLIAMENTARY MEDICAL CENTRE

1. Prince Pambo (Dr)*Specialist, Medical Director*
2. Kweku Owusu-Asare (Dr)*Physician Specialist*
3. Edna Abigail Thompson (Dr)*Principal Medical Officer*
4. Rahinatu Ibrahim (Dr)*Medical Officer*
5. Doreen Adu Danquah (Dr)*Principal Pharmacist*
6. Haleemah Maame Esi Pavis -Djre*Senior Nursing Officer*
7. Sedem Adamaley*Nursing Officer*
8. Mercy Yaa Boatemaa Appiah*Nursing Officer*
9. Priscilla Ansomah Osae*Staff Nurse*
10. Rosemond Quainoo*Principal Enrolled Nurse*
11. Juliana Messan*Deputy Chief Accountant*
12. Hope Agbodzakey*Principal Biomedical Scientist*
13. Suwebatu Seidu*Stenographer Secretary*
14. Maudlina Sanka*Principal Biostatistics Assistant*
15. Sadia Haruna*Dental Surgeon Technician*
16. Ernestina Ablordeppey*Asst. Chief Technical Officer (X – RAY)*
17. Maame Efua Egyima Annan*Registered Dietician*

NATIONAL AMBULANCE SERVICE STAFF

1. Gifty Ohenewah Asante*Advance Emergency Medical Technician*
2. Zakaria Tahiru Principal*Emergency Medical Technician*
3. Douglas Aninakwah*Principal Emergency Medical Technician*
4. Ebenezer Yeboah Senior*Emergency Medical Technician*
5. Doris Quarshie*Senior Emergency Medical Technician*
6. Cobby Obuobi*Senior Emergency Medical Technician*

Parliamentary Protection Unit

1. C/SUPT John Awini Afuugu
2. SUPT Tenkuu Simon
3. ASP Charles Djan
4. ASP Joyce Afi Ofori
5. ASP Maurice A. Surikuye
6. C/INSPR Alexander Aboagye
7. C/INSPR Benjamin Kudjo
8. C/INSPR Charles Dente
9. C/INSPR Jonathan K. Klutse
10. C/INSPR Kwabena Fosu
11. C/INSPR Mamudu Ali John
12. C/INSPR Michael Osei Boateng
13. C/INSPR Sulemana Yakubu
14. C/INSPR Prince Kodua Kesse
15. C/INSPR Emmanuel Gbedemah
16. C/INSPR David K. Nsuban
17. C/INSPR Daniel Kitcher
18. C/INSPR Sekyi Bernard Adu
19. C/INSPR Iddrisu Mohammed
20. C/INSPR James K. Dumson
21. C/INSPR John Doe Sorkpor

Parliament Fire Unit

1. DOII Victus Dzakpasu
2. DOIII Daniel Asamoah
3. DOIII Benedicta Bassaw
4. ADOI Nathaniel Nartey
5. ADOI Stella Barnor
6. ADOI Benoni Teye
7. ADOI Grace Enyonam Adjoa Dakeku
8. ADOII Jeffrey Ampiah
9. ADOII Moses Tarley
10. ADOII Felix Asare
11. STNOI Francis Nyanku
12. STNOI Justice Ofori
13. GOII Nketia Comfort
14. ASTNO Bannerman Alfred
15. ASTNO Charles Kabutey

THE PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

IN THE THIRD MEETING OF THE FIRST SESSION OF THE NINTH
PARLIAMENT OF THE FOURTH REPUBLIC OF GHANA
WHICH OPENED ON 21ST OCTOBER, 2025 IN THE THIRTY-THIRD YEAR OF
THE FOURTH REPUBLIC

FOURTH SERIES FIRST VOLUME OF SESSION VOLUME 130

THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Tuesday, 21st October, 2025

The House met at the Chamber, Parliament House, at 2:09 p.m.

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, I shall take a roll call of Members so I proceed to call upon the Clerks-at-the-Table to call out your names. I am sure you are all aware of the Standing Order on this matter. We are being guided by Order 14 of the Standing Orders of Parliament so please, the Clerks-at-the-Table may begin.

[ROLL CALL]

ANNOUNCEMENTS

The Speaker: Hon Members, I have received from the Electoral Commission, the Writs of Elections on the by-election held at Akwatia Constituency on 2nd September, 2025 and that of Tamale Central held on 23rd September, 2025.

I shall now proceed to read the communication.

The first is dated 4th September, 2025
and it reads:

**Communication from
the Electoral Commission**

The Speaker: The writ attached as you all know is a form of writ for public elections in Public Elections Regulation 2020 (CI 127), Form 1A. It reads;

Our Ref: C/EC.04/SF.2/Vol.18

THE CLERK TO PARLIAMENT
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA

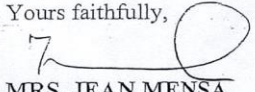
Dear Sir,

**SUBMISSION OF WRIT OF ELECTION FOR THE AKWATIA
PARLIAMENTARY BY-ELECTION HELD ON 2ND SEPTEMBER, 2025**

I bring you greetings from the Electoral Commission and trust that this letter finds you well.

Please find attached, the Writ of Election for the Akwatia Parliamentary By-Election held on Tuesday, 2nd September, 2025 in the Akwatia Constituency.

Thank you.

Yours faithfully,

MRS. JEAN MENSA
CHAIRPERSON

③ Clerk
Schedule for the
1st sitting of the 9th Parl
meeting of the 9th Parl
in Oct. 2025.
5/9/25 P.T.O.

④ DC LMS
Submitted for your
kind attention and
appropriate directive
please.
15-09-2025

② Rt Hon Speaker
Submitted for your
kind attention and
appropriate directive
please.
15-09-2025

5th Jomo Kenyatta Road, Ridge - Accra · P. O. Box: M 214, Accra, Ghana
Tel: (0)233 303 968 750 · Fax: +233(0) 302 221 007 · email: info@ec.gov.gh · website: www.ec.gov.gh · GPS Address: GA-079-8032



FORM OF WRI
PUBLIC ELECTIONS REGULAT

FORM ONE A

(Regulation 4 (2

WRIT OF ELE

TO THE RETURNING OFFICER FOR THE.....

WHEREAS Elections are to be held for the elec

WHEREAS there exists a vacancy in the M
the.....AKWATIA.....

NOW THEREFORE, I do hereby command
of a Member of Parliament to be held according
and that you do certify on this Writ the name of

I DO HEREBY DIRECT that the Nomi
the.....11TH.....day of.....AUG.....

to the.....13TH.....day of.....AUGUST.....a
and that the Poll shall be taken, if necessary, on

FORM ONE
(Regulation 43(1))



ELECTORAL COMMISSION
GHANA

CERTIFICATE TO BE ENDORSED ON WRIT

I HEREBY CERTIFY that the Member of Parliament elected for the AKWAFIA
Constituency in pursuance of this Writ is BERNARD BEDIAKO BADIO
and the number of votes cast in respect of each of the Candidates at the election is as follows

Candidates	Votes Obtained
1. <u>ASWADU SELENIEN</u>	<u>15 285</u>
2. <u>BERNARD BEDIAKO BADIO</u>	<u>18 199</u>
3. <u>OMUSU PATRICK</u>	<u>82</u>
4.	
5.	
6.	
7.	
8.	
9.	
10.	

Date 02/09/2025

OR

ERIC OMUSU SYRIFI

[Signature]
Returning Officer

I HEREBY CERTIFY that at the expiration of the time allowed for the delivery of
Nomination Forms no Candidate stood duly nominated in the.....
Constituency.

Date.....

OR

Returning Officer

I HEREBY CERTIFY that, by reason of the fact that an equal number of votes were found to
exist between the following Candidates.....

And by reason of the fact that the addition of a vote would have entitled any one of those
Candidates to be elected, no Member has been elected for the.....

.....Constituency

Date.....

Returning Officer



Our Ref: C/EC.04/SF.9/Vol.3/35

24TH SEPTEMBER, 2025

THE CLERK TO PARLIAMENT
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA

12.27.25

Dear Sir,

**SUBMISSION OF WRIT OF ELECTION FOR THE TAMALE CENTRAL
PARLIAMENTARY BY-ELECTION**

I bring you greetings from the Electoral Commission and trust that this letter finds you well.

Pursuant to Regulations 12 and 43 (2) (a), (b) of the Public Elections Regulations, 2020 C.I. 127, the Electoral Commission hereby informs you that, **Alidu Seidu Mahama**, the Parliamentary Candidate for the National Democratic Congress (NDC) for the Tamale Central Parliamentary By-Election has been elected unopposed.

Please find attached, the Writ of Election for the Tamale Central Parliamentary By-Election.

Thank you.

Yours faithfully,

MRS. JEAN MENSA
CHAIRPERSON

② Rt Hon Speaker
For your kind
attention and
appropriate
directive please
Stimulus
20-10-2025

(3) Clerk/Chair
B.U. to be read to
House on the day of
the swearing in
for 20/10/25



ELECTORAL COMMISSION
GHANA

FORM OF WRIT
PUBLIC ELECTIONS REGULATIONS, 2020 (C.I 127)

FORM ONE A

(regulation 4 (2))

WRIT OF ELECTION

TO THE RETURNING OFFICER FOR THE TAMALE CENTRAL
.....CONSTITUENCY

WHEREAS elections are to held for the election of a Member of Parliament;
WHEREAS there exists a vacancy in the Membership of Parliament for
the TAMALE CENTRAL.....Constituency;

NOW THEREFORE, I do hereby command that you cause the Election of
a Member of Parliament to be held according to law for the said Constituency
and that you do certify on this Writ the name of the person elected.

I DO HEREBY DIRECT that the Nomination shall take place from
the 8TH.....day of SEPTEMBER 2025

to the 10TH.....day of SEPTEMBER at TAMALE METRO E.C. OFFICE
and that the Poll shall be taken, if necessary, on the 30TH day of SEPTEMBER 2025

[Signature]
Chairperson, Electoral Commission
[P.T.O]

The certificate of endorsement reads:

FORM ONE B
(regulation 43 (1) (g))

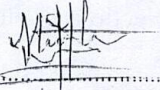

ELECTORAL COMMISSION
GHANA

CERTIFICATE TO BE ENDORSED ON WRIT

I HEREBY CERTIFY that the Member of Parliament elected for the TAMALE CENTRAL
Constituency in pursuance of this Writ is ALIDU SEIDU MAHAMA
and the number of votes cast in respect of each the Candidates at the election is as follows:

Candidates	Votes Obtained
1. <u>ALIDU SEIDU MAHAMA</u>	<u>UNOPPOSED</u>
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	
6.	
7.	
8.	
9.	
10.	

Date 23RD SEPTEMBER 2025 OR


Returning Officer
(MUNIRU MUSAH)

I HEREBY CERTIFY that at the expiration of the time allowed for the delivery of
Nomination Forms no Candidate stood duly nominated in the
Constituency.

Date..... OR
Returning Officer

I HEREBY CERTIFY that, by reasons of the fact that an equal number of votes were found
to exist between the following Candidates.....
.....

And by reason of the fact that the addition of a vote would have entitled any one of those
Candidates to be elected, no Member has been elected for the
..... Constituency.

Date.....
Returning Officer

E.L.1A

2:39 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, in accordance with Article 100 of the 1992 Constitution and Order 13(1) of the Standing Orders of Parliament, I shall now proceed to administer the Oaths. As you all know, a Member of Parliament elect may swear on the Bible, the Crucifix or the Quran; alternatively, a Member of Parliament elect may make and subscribe to a solemn affirmation.

Hon Members, pursuant to Order 13 (1) of the Standing Orders, I shall now invite the Hon Members of Parliament elect for the Akwatia Constituency and Tamale Central Constituency to proceed to the dais of the Speaker to take the Oath of Allegiance and the Oath of a Member of Parliament.

OATHS

[Mr Bernard Bediako Baidoo and Prof Seidu Mahama Alidu took and subscribed to the Oath of Allegiance and Oath of a Member of Parliament — Administered by the Rt Hon Speaker]

The Speaker: Hon Members, thank you for taking the Oaths. You are most welcome and I would hold you to the two Oaths that you have sworn; particularly, the one where you clearly stated that you would faithfully and contentiously discharge the duties of a Member of Parliament. So, to enable you discharge those duties, I would first give you the

“hoe” and the “cutlass”. One does not go to the farm without the hoe or the cutlass. On a daily basis, I observe Members when they walk in—Even though I am 33 years here, I still refer to the Constitution and the Standing Orders on a daily basis.

2:49 p.m.

There is always something to learn every day, and so I would hand this over to you. There are other documents that the Clerk’s Office will make available to you and please, if you really want to perform your duties well, you have to keep them with you. There is a lot that you have to learn. Whether you are a professor, a farmer, or you are from anywhere, you have come to a new school—*[Laughter]*—and that school starts from creche, today. Please do not assume that because of your capacity in other areas, you know it. You do not know it. You have to start learning.

Your seniors will do the usual thing. You have all been to school, and you have all passed through to the university. You know what seniors do to juniors. Do not be deterred and intimidated. You can perform better than them. But, at least, as for the respect and reverence, you have to give it to them because they were born before you. So, on behalf of the House, and the Members, I hand over this to you; first, to the Member of Parliament for the

Akwatia Constituency. *[Hear! Hear!]*
And second, to the Member of Parliament for Tamale Central Constituency. *[Hear! Hear!]*

[The Speaker presented the 1992 Constitution and Standing Orders to the Members of Parliament for the Akwatia and Tamale Central Constituencies]

The Speaker: Hon Members, on your behalf, I warmly welcome the two freshest Members of Parliament to our midst. We are happy to now have the full complement of the House. We now have 276 Members of Parliament. *[Hear! Hear!]* Please, the number is no longer 275; we have 276. Any time the number increases, we have to create space for the Member. So, it is a plea that before this number increases, you must, as a country, as a Republic, start looking for a proper place. If not, the integrity of this structure is being undermined. A word to the wise is enough.

By our Standing Orders, we now move to item numbered 4, which is National Pledge. All of you, I will listen to you delivering your pledges to the Nation. Not one by one, you do it together. *[Laughter]* Let us be on our feet.

[THE NATIONAL PLEDGE]

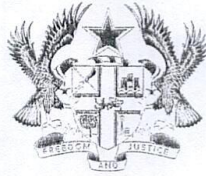
The Speaker: Thank you, Hon Members. You may resume your seats.

I believe that this is also a strong message to all Ghanaians, particularly our gallant Black Stars. Every Ghanaian must learn how to recite the National Pledge, and at the appropriate time, recite it with joy. You have to. Please, do not mumble. It is a very short one, very easy to recite.

COMMUNICATIONS FROM THE PRESIDENT

Nomination of Chief Justice

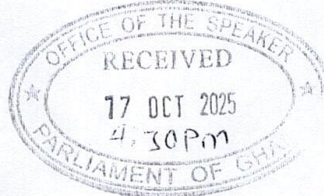
The Speaker: I have a few messages from His Excellency the President. Some, I will read; others, I will call on the Office of Chamber Reporting to capture them verbatim as they have been presented to this House. The one I will read deals with the nomination of the Chief Justice.



REPUBLIC OF GHANA

Jubilee House

The President



17th October, 2025

Rt. Hon Speaker,

NOMINATION OF CHIEF JUSTICE

Following consultations with the Council of State, conveyed by its letter dated 14th October 2025, and in accordance with Article 144(1) of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, I have the honour to respectfully submit, for the approval of Parliament, the nomination of Justice Paul Baffoe-Bonnie as Chief Justice of the Republic of Ghana.

Justice Baffoe-Bonnie has distinguished himself through unwavering integrity, sound judicial temperament, and a deep commitment to the rule of law. His long and meritorious service on the Supreme Court has been characterised by professionalism, fairness, and a passion for justice. He possesses the necessary leadership, administrative competence, and vision to advance ongoing reforms within Ghana's justice system and to further strengthen public confidence in the Judiciary.

Attached are the nominee's Curriculum Vitae and supporting documents to facilitate the vetting process. I trust that Parliament will expedite the approval process in accordance with constitutional requirements.

Please accept, Mr. Speaker, the assurances of my highest regard.

(2) Clerk/Under
B. u. to be read
to the House
on 10/10/25
**THE RIGHT HONOURABLE SPEAKER
PARLIAMENT OF GHANA
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA**

JOHN DRAMANI MAHAMA

2:59 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I accordingly proceed to refer the said nomination to the appropriate Committee, which is the Appointments Committee, to hold the public hearing and submit a report to the House for consideration. As you know, by our rules, other Members of Parliament are permitted to attend the sittings of the Committee, in fact, all Committees. It is just that you do not have the right to vote, but you can attend to assist your Colleagues.

We trust that this will be done in accordance with the laws of this country. Please, we will give you ample time for us to assist His Excellency to ensure that the confidence in the arms of government is restored and enhanced.

Referred to the Appointments Committee

The Speaker: There are two more that I have to read. One deals with the demise of our compatriots, and we have been given notice. The letter is dated 7th August, 2025, and it reads:

Notice of Demise

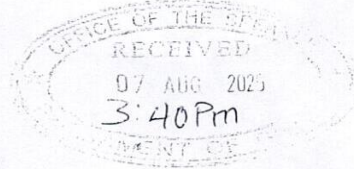


REPUBLIC OF GHANA

Jubilee House

The President

7th August, 2025



Rt. Hon. Speaker,

NOTICE OF DEMISE

It is with profound sorrow and a heavy heart that I write to inform you formally and the Honourable House of the tragic loss of two distinguished Ministers of State:

1. Hon. Dr. Edward Omane Boamah, Minister for Defence; and
2. Hon. Dr. Mohammed Murtala, Minister for Environment, Science and Technology.

These two exemplary public servants, whose contributions to national development were marked by diligence, patriotism, and an abiding commitment to the public good, sadly lost their lives in a fatal helicopter crash on the 6th of August, 2025.

We are also deeply grieved to report additional casualties:

1. Alhaji Muniru Mohammed
2. Dr. Samuel Sarpong
3. Mr. Samuel Aboagye
4. Squadron Leader Peter Bafemi Anala
5. Flying Officer Twum Ampadu
6. Sergeant Ernest Addo

Please accept, Rt. Hon. Speaker, the assurances of my highest consideration.

(3) Clerk/Usher
B. U. to be read to
the House
SM 11/8/25

JOHN DRAMANI MAHAMA

RT. HON. SPEAKER OF PARLIAMENT
PARLIAMENT OF GHANA
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA

The Speaker: Hon Members, I think it is proper for us to stand in honour to give our departed compatriots a minute's silence.

[A minute's silence was observed.]

The Speaker: May their souls and the souls of all the faithfully departed rest in perfect peace. Amen.

Some Hon Members: Amen.

The Speaker: Hon Members, as a result of the sudden departure of our two Ministers of state in such a horrific manner, His Excellency the President

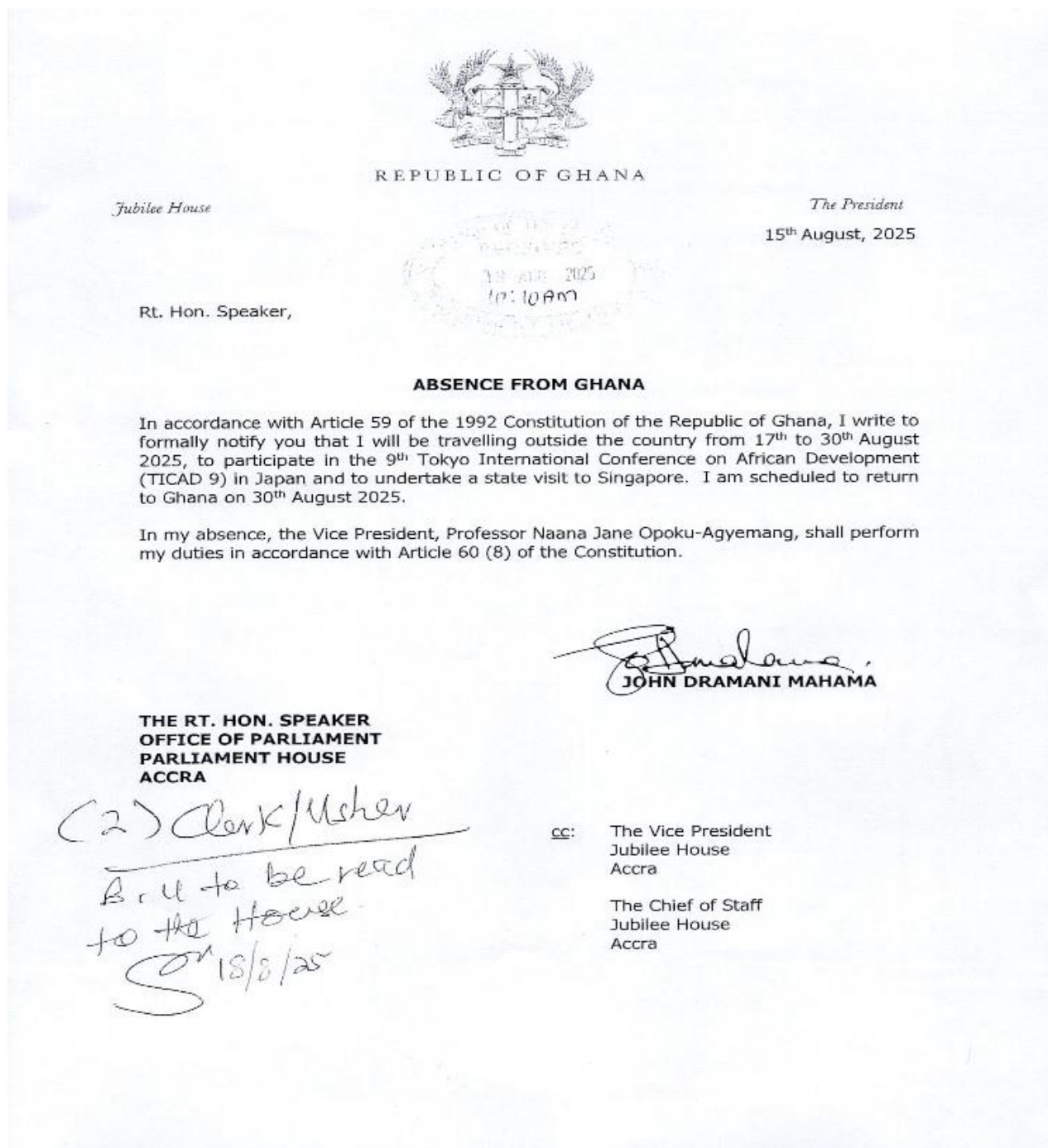
proceeded to designate caretaker Ministers. The letter to me is dated 7th August, 2025, and it reads:

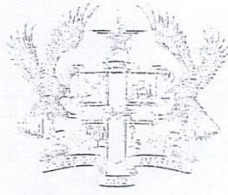
Designation of Caretaker Ministers



The Speaker: The rest of the letters, the communication from His Excellency the President, deal with absence from Ghana. There are a number of them and I would on your behalf refer them to the Office of Chamber Reporting to capture them verbatim in our proceedings as having been read to the House. Please, with your kind permission, I do so now.

Absence from Ghana





REPUBLIC OF GHANA

19th September, 2025

Rt. Hon. Speaker,

2025
17.07hrs**ABSENCE FROM GHANA**

In accordance with Article 59 of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, I write to formally notify you that I shall travel outside the country on Saturday, 20th September 2025, to New York, United States of America, to participate in the 80th Session of the United Nations General Assembly, which is scheduled to take place from 20th to 30th September 2025. I shall return to Ghana on Tuesday, 30th September 2025.

In my absence, the Vice President, Professor Naana Jane Opoku-Agyemang, shall, in accordance with Article 60(8) of the Constitution, perform my functions.

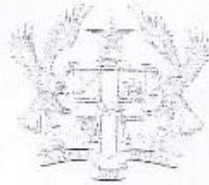
Kindly accept the assurances of my highest consideration.

JOHN DRAMANI MAHAMA

**THE RT. HON. SPEAKER
OFFICE OF PARLIAMENT
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA**

cc: The Vice President
Jubilee House
Accra

The Chief of Staff
Jubilee House
Accra



REPUBLIC OF GHANA

19th September, 2025

Rt. Hon. Speaker,

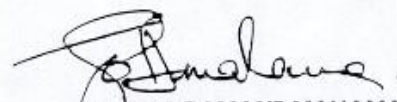
17/09/25

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JOHN DRAMANI MAHAMA

**THE RT. HON. SPEAKER
OFFICE OF PARLIAMENT
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA**

cc: The Vice President
Jubilee House
Accra

The Chief of Staff
Jubilee House
Accra

FORMAL COMMUNICATION BY THE SPEAKER

Welcome Address by the Rt Hon Speaker

The Speaker: In view of the nature of Business before the House, the item numbered 6 would be to welcome you all to the Third Meeting of the First Session of the Ninth Parliament of the Fourth Republic of Ghana. I am happy you took the recess seriously, and from the reports I have, many of you interacted with your constituents on whose behalf you are here. I am informed that you shared information with them on the work of Parliament and received a lot of input from your constituents.

Committees also took advantage to visit a number of places, particularly government agencies and projects to play their oversight roles. There were a number of delegations to represent Ghana outside, particularly as they now place a lot of emphasis on parliamentary diplomacy. It is becoming a function of parliaments in the world – parliamentary diplomacy. Apart from that, a lot of you also took time to benchmark, learn from other jurisdictions so that we could adopt and adapt what is suitable to our situation in Ghana, and equally share what we have here with brothers and sisters all over the world. We will deal with them in detail later on. My duty is just to welcome you, and you are to expect the agenda of this Meeting from the Clerk to Parliament. You will be given copies. We have not finalised it because

Leadership is still in discussion with the Government so that we could get total Government Business for this Meeting.

For Parliamentary Business, we have what we have to do for this Third Meeting, and some of you are also submitting Private Businesses which are all part of the Business of the House. So, we have not firmed it up yet until Hon Leaders together with the ministers come out with a position which by a procedure, the Speaker has to admit before it is referred to the Clerk who will put it before the Business Committee for them to schedule weekly for our attention.

Please, you are warmly welcome and I will proceed now to give opportunity to your Leaders. If they have some words, they will share with us before we get to the next items. I will do so by starting with the Hon Minority Leader. Please Minority Leader, you have some time to say a few words of welcome to your Hon Colleagues from the recess. We say recess; they recede from Plenary session to engage in other functions of the House outside Plenary session. Members of Parliament do not go on holidays or vacation. They recede to continue to do the work of a Member of Parliament. I think it is something that we have to consider because the Labour Act expects that you should also have some leave. It is done all over the world. Members of Parliament have leave, so that they can rest. Those of us who have sacrificed all these years, we know how our families have been destroyed because we never had time for our families. You never

have time for people dear to your heart, the people that you grew with, and sometimes, they do not spare you. Please let us think about it. Discuss it with our neighbours outside Parliament and at least get a few days to have some breathing space not to rest but to share love with our immediate family members.

With this, Hon Minority Leader, you may proceed to make your comments.

Remarks by the Minority Leader

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, let me thank you for the opportunity to make my remarks as we reconvene for the Third Meeting of the First Session of the Ninth Parliament. Mr Speaker, I begin by warmly welcoming your good self, your deputies, Hon Colleagues in Leadership and all Members of this House back to our Legislative duties. I also extend this welcome to the Clerk to Parliament and his deputies, the dedicated staff of the Parliamentary Service and Members of the Parliamentary Press Corp whose support remain invaluable to the work we do.

During the recess, we were struck with sorrow with the passing of eight distinguished citizens who served Ghana with dedication and honour. We mourn our respected Colleague Hon Dr Murtala Muhammed Ibrahim, Member of Parliament for Tamale Central and Minister for Environment, Science, and

Technology. We also remember Dr Edward Omane Boamah, Minister for Defence; Alhaji Muniru Mohammed, Acting Deputy National Security Coordinator; Dr Samuel Sarpong, Vice Chairman of the National Democratic Congress; Samuel Aboagye, former parliamentary candidate; Squadron Leader Peter Bafemi Anala, Flying Officer Manin Twum-Ampadu, and Sergeant Ernest Addo Mensah. Mr Speaker, the Minority extends its deepest condolences to their families, loved ones, and all who mourn their loss. May their souls rest in perfect peace even as we are inspired by their dedicated service to recommit to public service with dignity, courage, and honour.

Mr Speaker, we today also welcome two new Members of Parliament to be sworn in to fill the vacancies of Akwatia and Tamale Central Constituencies. Their arrival is a solemn reminder of both the grief we share and the hope we carry for renewed service.

Mr Speaker, the state of our nation's governance presents a mix of trials and opportunities. From economic hardships on the home front to unsettling developments on the international stage. These past months have tested Ghana's resilience. Mr Speaker, Ghanaians remain concerned about the economy. While recent indicators show modest macroeconomic gains, these are yet to bring real relief to ordinary citizens. The truth is, stabilisation means little if the youth remain unemployed and families still struggle with the cost of living. The

mass dismissals across key state institutions represent a direct assault on the integrity of the public service. Competent officers who were employed have been sacked from office under directives from the Chief of Staff. These dismissals were carried out without due process, without cause and in clear violation of constitutional and statutory provisions. These are politically motivated acts that undermine professionalism, weaken state institutions, and erode public confidence in governance.

The recent labour unrest while we were on break shows a clear public discontent. Over 200 junior doctors have worked for 10 months without pay and more than 800 remain unposted. Newly trained teachers and nurses have also gone months without salaries. These are the stories of hardship people face. A government that fails to pay its frontline workers cannot claim to care for its people.

Mr Speaker, it must be emphasised that the NPP government while in office, initiated the One District One Factory which was conceived as a vehicle to drive industrial growth and create sustainable jobs through private sector participation. However, government actions in recent months show a clear lack of commitment to that vision. Instead of providing real support to existing private enterprises and easing the cost of doing business, bureaucracies are being created, frustrating investors and entrepreneurs. This stifles

innovation, discourages productivity, and risks choking the public sector with inefficiencies that the private sector was meant to relieve. But Mr Speaker, no economy can grow when private initiative is replaced with political control. The time has come for government to walk the talk of ensuring the private sector becomes the real engine of growth. Enough of the rhetorics. The 24-Hour Economy must not be an empty talk. It must provide a hope for many youth who expect jobs.

Mr Speaker, on the governance front, governance is about upholding freedom, justice, and the rule of law. The frequent arrest of opposition figures, journalists, and ordinary citizens on flimsy and politically motivated charges exemplify a pattern of harassment intended to silence dissent. They paint a troubling picture of a shrinking civic space in our democracy. Even more disturbing, young Ghanaians expressing frustration on social media have been targeted, questioned, and in some cases detained.

3:19 p.m.

The question we ask as a Minority is, is this the reset we were promised or an era of regression into intolerance?

Mr Speaker, the case of David Kwodow Prah Afful, a young man known on social media as “Kwame Nkrumah II”, highlights the disturbing double standards in how justice is applied. After a live stream on social media, he was swiftly arrested,

prosecuted and sentenced to seven months in prison. Much as the law must be applied, we must ask, is the state equally swift when government-affiliated individuals commit similar or worse infractions? Not long before this incident, during the Akwatia by-election, the National Democratic Congress (NDC) National Vice Chairman, Sofo Azorka, openly declared that there will be by-election in my constituency. That was a threat; plain and simple. Unlike in the case of Kwame Nkrumah II, the Police have not taken action. Mr Speaker, why is there no urgency on this matter? Why the speed in one case and silence in another? Justice must be seen to be done. Justice cannot be harsh on critics and lenient on those who are closer to power.

The broader context deepens our concern. Mr Speaker, on 8th September, the Bono Regional Chairman of the New Patriotic Party (NPP), Mr Kwame Baffoe, popularly known as “Abronye DC”, was arrested and detained on charges that appear politically motivated. The court ruling in this case raises deeper constitutional questions. In delivering judgement, the presiding judge, His Lordship Bright Acquah, cited George Orwell’s *Animal Farm*, observing that, “All men are equal, but some are more equal than others”. He went on to quote the late President Robert Mugabe, purportedly, “I can assure you of freedom of speech, but cannot assure you of freedom after speech”.

Mr Speaker, these remarks to us as the Minority, coming from the Bench, convey an unsettling message that equality before the law and freedom of expression may no longer be treated as fundamental rights, but as privileges subject to interpretation and power. Such reasoning, if left unchecked, sets a worrying precedent for democratic governance and judicial independence. The use of Orwell and supposed quote from Mugabe to rationalise the restriction of free speech undermines the spirit of our Constitution, which guarantees every citizen the right to express opinion without fear of reprisal.

Ghana’s courts have long stood as the last line of defence for liberty and any departure from that role risks eroding public confidence in justice itself. The Minority, therefore, finds this trend dangerous and calls for restraint, reflection, and a renewed commitment to fairness, equality, and the true meaning of freedom under the rule of law.

Mr Speaker, the Minority registers its unequivocal objection to the removal of the Chief Justice, Mrs Gertrude Araba Esaaba Sackey Torkornoo. We believe the process lacked transparency, violated constitutional principles, and set a dangerous precedent for judicial interference. Three separate petitions were referred to the Pwamang Committee. The committee only heard one petition, then adjourned proceedings for continuation on 15th September. Yet, without notice to any party in the matter, the committee suddenly submitted a

report on 1st September, and within two hours, an announcement was made of a removal. Was that adjournment a deception, Mr Speaker?

Even more troubling was a warrant of the suspension. It claimed to have made a *prima facie* determination, but to date, no one has seen the said document, and this raises serious constitutional questions. The so-called Pwamang Report remains a secret document. We, the Minority, shall not relent on our demand for a copy and a full disclosure of this report.

Mr Speaker, this matter goes beyond one individual. If this false and irregular process succeeds, it endangers every independent constitutional body. The Auditor-General, the Electoral Commission, the National Commission for Civic Education, and even the Public Services Commission could be targeted next under the same Article 146 procedure. The question that must even be asked is that, when a person is removed as a Chief Justice, does he or she remain a justice of the Supreme Court? This would destroy the safeguards of accountability and erase the principle of probity from our governance. If judicial independence can be manipulated in this manner, we should not expect free or credible elections in the future.

Mr Speaker, the Judiciary is the last line of defence for our democracy and any act that undermines its independence strikes at the heart of our constitutional

order. The Minority will resist any attempt to compromise the sanctity of the Judiciary. Ghana's institutions must be protected from political manipulation and we will not sit idly by while dangerous precedents are set.

On the issue of illegal mining, popularly known as *galamsey*, we, the Minority, are of the view that it represents one of Ghana's gravest governance challenges that has persisted across successive governments and has escalated into a full-blown national crisis. The devastation caused by *galamsey* to our environment, water bodies, and public health cannot be overstated. Even as we convene today, Mr Speaker, our rivers run brown with pollution. Vast tracts of once-fertile land lie scarred and toxic, and many of our citizens in mining communities face illness and danger from poisonous chemicals. We have talked about illegal mining for years, yet the problem has only grown worse. Time for mere talk is over. We need decisive, visionary action now to save our country's future from disaster.

Not long ago, we were warned. One such early warning came in 2010, when investigative journalist, Anas Aremeyaw Anas released a documentary exposing the dark underbelly of *galamsey*. That exposé, part of the *Africa Investigates* series, shone a light on the tragic consequences of illegal mining that were already evident back then. The documentary recounted how in June 2010, a *galamsey* pit near Dunkwa-on-

Offin flooded, killing an estimated 150 people in a single disaster. It showed the rampant corruption and complicity that allowed *galamsey* to flourish, including officials meant to enforce the law taking bribes to look the other way.

It highlighted the environmental havoc being unleashed, rivers poisoned with mercury, cyanide, and other toxins, local communities suffering flooding and pollution, fishermen and farmers losing their livelihood. Anas' work in 2010 was an early warning alert for our nation. Then again in 2015, Finance Minister, Mr Seth Terkper again brought this up at a Finance Committee hearing in Parliament when discussing reasons for the declining cocoa production in Ghana.

Tragically, Mr Speaker, those warnings were not heeded with the urgency and seriousness they deserved. Fast forward to today, the nightmare scenario is upon us. Just last month, a new study by Pure Earth and Ghana's own Environmental Protection Authority (EPA), revealed terrifying data about toxin levels in mining communities. In some areas, mercury contamination in the soil is 134 times above safe levels and arsenic concentrations are over 4,000 per cent higher than what the World Health Organization (WHO) deems safe. These poisonous metals are seeping into the water, food crops and the very bodies of our people.

3.29 p.m.

Doctors are reporting an uptick in children from mining areas developing

kidney disorders and even finding mercury pellets in their x-rays. Mr Speaker, children, now require dialysis because of the poisonous fruits of *galamsey*. Our nation's future is being sickened and stunted.

Mr Speaker, despite being Ghana's top gold producer, the surge in unregulated small-scale mining has created an underground economy that drains national resources and benefits criminal networks. In just eight months, this year, small-scale gold exports surged to over US\$6.3 billion, according to the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Ghana Gold Board. However, much of this trade is believed to be illicit. The state loses billions in revenue while communities suffer environmental devastation. The Minority stands with all Ghanaians calling for decisive action. We welcome the advocacy from civil society and religious leaders, and we support real solutions from tougher laws to sustainable alternatives.

Mr Speaker, we must also admit that the situation has worsened since this Government came into office. At the 2025 May Day celebrations, Organised Labour, speaking through its Secretary-General, confronted this matter with deep disappointment that the *galamsey* menace has worsened under the watch of this Government, barely five months into its administration. The Trade Union Congress' (TUC) position was again echoed by the acting Chief Justice, Justice Paul Baffoe-Bonnie, at the Ghana Bar Association (GBA) Conference in

Wa, where he also described the crisis as worsening. Mr Speaker, when Organised Labour and the Judiciary raise their voices together, we must listen because these are not partisan voices. The time to act is now. If we fail to protect our rivers, land and communities, we risk failing an entire generation.

Mr Speaker, during the recess, a foreign policy development came to light regarding an agreement between the Government of Ghana and the United States of America to accept some deportees. The agreement of such magnitude, in our view, and we respectfully submit, should be subject to parliamentary scrutiny under Article 75 of the 1992 Constitution.

We therefore demand that this arrangement be brought before Parliament for ratification. Ghana's foreign policy must never be conducted in secrecy, nor should we compromise our sovereignty for expediency. We urge the Government to always place Ghana's dignity first and ensure that any international agreement reflects our values and commands the confidence of the Ghanaian people.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, it is worth emphasising that Ghana's story is of triumphs achieved through visionary leadership and the indomitable spirit of our people. The New Patriotic Party (NPP), during its time in government, championed bold initiatives that delivered tangible progress. We rolled out the Free SHS Policy, which opened

doors for secondary education to youth from all walks of life. We pursued industrialisation through the 1D1F Programme, establishing 169 new factories nationwide, creating nearly 170,000 jobs for our citizens, constructing over 13,000 kilometres of roads, championing Science Technology Engineering and Mathematics (STEM), making Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) free, with all TVET institutions being facelifted.

Mr Speaker, this is the record of the previous government. Under the NPP's stewardship, Ghana's democracy deepened and the economy grew to the extent that the world took notice. We therefore urge this Government to walk the talk by being bold with policy implementation. Enough of the rhetoric of a 24-hour economy! We have heard one job, three shifts, enough of it. We want the reality to be seen on the streets of Accra.

Mr Speaker, finally, we cannot afford to lose hope. Our nation has weathered many storms, and each time we have emerged stronger. The Minority will continue to be the voice and the shield of the people in this august House. Though we are 87, we assure the people of Ghana that we are firm in our conviction and we will be able to hold this super Majority to account. We do not believe in numbers, we believe in substance, and we will confront you with substance. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Speaker, we are a proud, mighty few. We would speak truth to power and work tirelessly, guided by discipline, hard work and our faith in God. Mr Speaker, inspired by your own hard work when your party lost in 2000, you led the charge with fewer numbers and within a short period you made progress. We are also inspired by what we saw in 2016, such that by 2020 your Side had made progress. We believe in that same dream that come 2028, the Minority will be the Majority. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Speaker, let us all in President Akufo-Addo's words, be citizens, not spectators. I thank you so much for your kind audience and I thank Colleagues for indulging.

The Speaker: Hon Members, before I invite the Majority Leader, let me acknowledge the presence of our august visitors. I think they just give an indication some have to move to do other businesses. We have three groups of visitors from the following constituencies, Sagnarigu, Akwatia and Tamale.

We have Tamale Senior High School, my alma mater, led by Chris Avia, who is the Board Chairman of the school. They are 60 in number; 60 of them all the way from Sagnarigu. Please, you are welcome. I spent some years in your constituency to educate myself at Tamale, that time we called it secondary school, not senior high. So, we are happy to have you here to see what we do here.

Thank you so much for taking the trouble to come down and I am sure your student parliament will learn a lot from this and join so that you grow up with this culture. You are most welcome. Please, you may resume your seats.

[Students of Tamale Senior High School were acknowledged]

The Speaker: We have constituents from Akwatia constituency, led by the District Chief Executive (DCE), Hon Umar Ahmed. They are 82 in number. I think they have moved out. I am sure it is after we swore in the Member of Parliament (MP), they decided to follow the MP.

[Members of the Akwatia Constituency were acknowledged]

The Speaker: We also have constituents from Tamale Central constituency, led by Fuseini Yussif, who is the secretary to the group. There are 102 in number. You are all welcome to your House.

[Members of the Tamale Central Constituency were acknowledged]

3:39 p.m.

Hon Members, I will now invite the Majority Leader to give you warm words of welcome.

[Hear! Hear!]

Remarks by the Majority Leader

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Rt Hon Alban Sumana Kingsford Bagbin, the Hon Deputy Speakers, Hon Colleagues, Members of Parliament, representing the 276 constituencies presently constituting the House, the Clerk to Parliament and the Parliamentary Service Staff. By the grace of the Almighty, we are all here and welcome back to this House for the Third Meeting of the First Session of the Ninth Parliament. We have been duly summoned back by our most able Rt Hon Speaker, who remains a pillar of parliamentary democracy in the annals of our democracy's history. *[Hear! Hear!]* We continue to thank you Mr Speaker for your continued defence of the independence and autonomy of this House as a coordinate branch of government.

I begin on a very solemn note. We must start by remembering our colleagues who died in that tragic helicopter crash of 6th August, 2025. The Rt Hon Speaker has already mentioned their names, but suffice it to add that two were particularly close to us. Hon Dr Edward Kofi Omane Boamah, a non-voting member of this House and then Minister for Defence, and Hon Alhaji Dr Murtala Ibrahim, the then Member of Parliament for Tamale Central and Minister for Environment, Science and Technology. The other distinguished Ghanaians who perished in the fatal accident have all been mentioned and I would urge Colleagues to remember

them in their prayers. And on behalf of Colleagues in this House, let me extend our condolences to the families of the bereaved and urge us all to support the efforts to maintain their children. A minute of silence has already been observed in remembrance of our Colleagues. Let me thank this House for that.

Mr Speaker, this loss occasioned a by-election in the Tamale Central and in addition to an earlier loss of our Colleague which also occasioned another by-election in Akwatia. Mr Speaker, in the two by-elections, the National Democratic Congress (NDC) party won the elections. Mr Speaker, winning Akwatia about eight months in office signals the growing popularity of the NDC in government and general public positive rating of the Government of the NDC under President John Dramani Mahama. *[Hear! Hear!]* Mr Speaker, with these two elections and the one that took place in Ablekuma, this House is now fully constituted. The independent Members of this House remain four. The New Patriotic Party (NPP), which previously had a micro-minority of 88, has had its number shrink further to 87.

Mr Speaker, I believe they are no longer a micro-minority but a minuscule minority. *[Laughter]* Mr Speaker, micro could actually be a large number because micro is a unit of measurement. One million can actually be micro when you are evaluating one billion. In English, when you want to describe something as

very small, you say minuscule. *[Laughter]* The NDC super-majority will balloon to 185 and when we add our numbers to the four independents who have agreed to do business with us, the NDC will become a gargantuan majority. *[Hear! Hear!]* All I can say is, so far, so excellent. *[Hear! Hear!]*

During recess, MPs had the opportunity to observe the impact of work we did during our previous Meetings: the budget we approved, the laws we passed and the policies underpinning them. Our engagements revealed a persistent urgent need to address youth unemployment. We must ensure that our laws and the policies that we enact create jobs. Ghana's population still remains very young. Citizens aged 15 to 35 make up over 38 per cent of the population and 60 per cent of the labour force. They face enormous barriers to economic inclusion. Indeed, they want jobs. In the 2024 Afrobarometer report of the Centre for Democratic Development (CDD), concerns about unemployment were the topmost of most Ghanaians. This was followed by the management of the economy and then infrastructure.

During this Meeting of Parliament, Hon Members will focus on reviewing job creation policies of the various sectors. We propose to hold a special parliamentary hearing on the extractive industries with a view to exploring the impact on beneficial national economic development, overall benefit to the country and in particular, the extent to which local content legislation are being

enforced to create jobs for Ghanaians and ownership of the extractive industries. Every sector of our economy has a job creation potential and our debates and deliberations in this meeting will focus on how this Parliament would hold sector heads accountable for ensuring that jobs are indeed created to the benefit of the Ghanaian youth. In this regard, most Committees will be requested to conduct hearings on the extent of job creation policies and programmes of the various sectors so we can enhance efforts towards job creation.

Indeed, during the recess, we had the opportunity for Committees to engage in field visits and engage with interest groups and governmental agencies and we observed firsthand, the impacts of the financial budget and economic policies and legislation we passed in previous Meetings of Parliament. Mr Speaker, I am proud to say that so far, so excellent. *[Hear! Hear!]*

The energy sector is doing very well and electricity has remained on, empowering growth. So far, so excellent. The economy is rebounding and Ghana, once again, is gaining economic respectability globally. So far, so excellent. The Ghana cedi is gaining strength and stabilising. So far, so excellent. Inflation has come down to single-digit and prices are coming down and life is becoming affordable to the ordinary Ghanaian. So far, so excellent. We are paying our debts and at the same time we are not accumulating needless debts. So far, so excellent. We are

spending on the right things and within our means. We are spending, but spending wisely. So far, so excellent.

3:49 p.m.

Our schools are functioning well and Free SHS is well funded, and we have not experienced any disruption of the school calendar in our constituencies during recess. Let me repeat. Our schools are functioning well; Free SHS is well funded, and we have not experienced any disruption of schools or school calendar in our constituencies. So far, so excellent.

Mr Speaker, the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) has paid a total of GH¢2.84 billion in claims to accredited health care providers across the country. This represents the most consistent payment trend since the Scheme's inception. The New Democratic Congress (NDC) are the best implementers of social intervention schemes. As I address you, there are no areas outstanding. Claim payments are now up to date with reimbursements made monthly, a marked improvement from previous years when payments delayed for several months. This improvement has restored confidence among health care providers, stabilised service delivery and enhanced the Scheme's credibility across all regions.

Additionally, the uncapping of the National Health Insurance Levy (NHIL) by his Excellency President John Dramani Mahama has released an

additional GH¢3.4 billion to the NHIA, marking a historic fiscal breakthrough that secures sustainable funding for timely claim payment, expansion of coverage, and implementation of flagship reforms such as Free Primary Health Care and Mahama Cares. So far, so excellent. Mr Speaker, the health insurance scheme is on track to reach an unprecedented 20 million active members by end of year 2025. So far, so excellent. Our hospitals and health facilities are being well funded, and Mr Speaker, I can only say good things will happen to this country.

Mr Speaker, our Metropolitan Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs) are very well financially lubricated with prompt transfers of 80 per cent of the Common Fund allocations. Total disbursement for the first quarter of 2025 was GH¢711,334,852.56. That is the first quarter. Second quarter, 2025 disbursement was also completed on 21st August, 2025 and this was GH¢1,318,484,908. Mr Speaker, these disbursements are boosting local economies as procurements which must be done at that level are being done to create local jobs and opportunities. So far, so excellent. Many progressive initiatives we approved in this House in the last Meetings have been launched and are on course. Notably, the Big Push in road infrastructure is on course. So far, so excellent.

Mr Speaker, Global InfoAnalytics did some polls which released on July 1,

2025 and they revealed that 70 per cent of Ghanaians believe the country is on the right track. Seventy per cent of Ghanaians believe the country is on the right track. So far, so excellent. As of September 2025, Global InfoAnalytics' survey indicates that 58 per cent believe the Government was doing enough to fight corruption and 53 per cent said corruption had improved. So far, so excellent. A similar report of Global InfoAnalytics in 2024 revealed that 65 per cent of Ghanaians believe that the country was headed in a wrong direction. There is a clear turnaround in how Ghanaians perceive their country and their government now. We must stay the course in this direction and the work of this Meeting of Parliament must keep the pressure on the Executive to keep delivering. In this regard, I want to assure Ghanaians that the overwhelming NDC Majority will not treat our counterparts in the Executive with kid gloves. We will continue to demand performance and delivery of promises made in our manifesto. Bipartisanship shall be our hallmark so we will tolerate our minuscule Minority and heed sound and genuine criticism.

Mr Speaker, this is the Meeting when Budget will be considered. We will be receiving the 2026 Budget Statement in due course. But the signs of a very positive development are already clear. Ninety-five per cent of Ghanaians in a survey conducted by professional service firm PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC) in July 2025, believe the macroeconomic performance of the country in the first

half of the year has met or exceeded expectations. Indeed, even members of the New Patriotic Party (NPP) cannot deny the fact that the indicators are looking very good. So far, so excellent.

Mr Speaker, we in the NDC are governing well. The president of IMANI Centre for Policy and Education, Franklin Cudjoe, on 5th July 2025, strongly endorsed the recent decision of President John Dramani Mahama to scrap fuel allowances and allocations for all political appointees, describing it as a wonderful initiative. There are so many other wonderful initiatives that should be codified into law to prevent future reversal. So far, so excellent.

On 10th October, 2025, the International Monetary Fund (IMF) stated that the economy of Ghana is rebounding faster than anticipated, with macroeconomic stabilisation taking root, following a strong performance in the first half of 2025, underpinned by strong services activity, agricultural output and others. The IMF has also lauded Ghana on recent stabilisation of the cedi, noting that the development signals improvement in the economic fundamentals of the country, renewed policy credibility and investor confidence. So far, so excellent.

On 7th May, 2025, Bloomberg rated the Ghanaian cedi as the best performing currency in the second quarter. So far, so excellent. The positive endorsement of policies and programmes this House approved keep coming locally and

internationally. During a high-level meeting in Washington DC, the president of the African Development Bank, Dr Sidi Ould Tah, described the Gold Board under the new President John Dramani Mahama-led administration, as a timely innovation that aligns with the African Development Bank's efforts to promote responsible resource management and fiscal sustainability. So far, so excellent.

The economist, chartered accountant and banker, Dr Akwesi Agyeman, in his mid-year economic review of 2025, stated that Ghana's political reset in 2025 has coincided with an unmistakable economic rebound. Inflation is easing, the Ghanaian cedi has steadied, business activity is picking up, and this grants the new administration its first real chance to rewrite the country's stop-start growth story. Mr Speaker, to cap it all, we are going to the World Cup in America [*Hear! Hear!*] So far, so excellent.

So much has been achieved so far within a short time, but a lot remains to be done. We are not out of the woods yet, and many things must change. Recently, we placed senior high school students. The lobby to get into grade 'A' schools revealed a malice that must be fixed in our educational sector. There must be no grade 'A' school and no grade 'B' schools. We spend equally on all teachers in all schools. We in this Parliament must do whatever it takes to fix all schools and demand equal performance. We pay all schools equally.

3:59 p.m.

This House must begin to demand accountability and the greatest standards of performance from all our services—Education Service, Health Service, Judicial Service and all the Public Services of Ghana. Reforming attitudes there must engage our attention. The Reset Agenda must permeate our public services.

Mr Speaker, the story of Ghana is now being told in a positive light on all international platforms. The Reset Agenda of President John Dramani Mahama and the NDC party is on course. This House will sustain that agenda in this Meeting. We will demand accountability for past acts of corruption and abuse of power, and gross mismanagement of the economy. We will demand the full implementation of the report of the Operation Recover All Loot (ORAL). [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Speaker, my team has engaged the various sector Ministers with a view to understanding the weight of Government Business to be brought before us during this Meeting. If they all receive the expected Cabinet approvals, we could have a heavy legislative programme in addition to the usual, very involving consideration of the National Budget. The Ministry of Health has planned to seek our approval for the:

- i. National Health Insurance Regulations, 2025.

- ii. National Vaccine Institute Regulations, 2025.
- iii. Ghana Medical Trust Fund Regulations, 2025.
- iv. Allied Health Professional Council Regulations, 2025.

The Ministry of Education will seek the passage of:

- i. Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology Bill, 2025.
- ii. Change of University Names: Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development; SD Dombo University of Business and Integrated Development Studies; CK Tadem University of Technology and Applied Sciences. These have all since been directed by the Cabinet.
- iii. Ghana Book Development Council Bill, 2025.
- iv. University of Engineering and Agricultural Sciences (UEAS), Bunso Bill, 2025.
- v. Colleges of Education (Amendment) Bill, 2025.

- vi. Chartered Institute of Procurement and Supply Chain Bill, 2025.
- vii. National Teaching Council Regulations, 2025.
- viii. National Council for Curriculum and Assessment Regulations, 2025.
- ix. National Schools Inspectorate Authority Regulations, 2025.
- x. Ghana Tertiary Education Commission Regulations, 2025.

The Ministry of Transport will seek passage of:

- i. Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill, 2025.
- ii. Road Traffic (Amendment) Regulations, 2025.
- iii. Road Traffic (Amendment) Regulations, 2025.
- iv. Ghana Shippers Authority Regulations, 2025.
- v. Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority Bill, 2025.
- vi. Ratification of the Africa Road Safety Charter.

The Ministry of the Interior will seek the expeditious passage of:

- i. Security and Intelligence Agencies Bill, 2025.
- ii. Immigration Service (Amendment) Regulations, 2025.
- iii. Prisons Service (Parole) Regulations, 2025.
- iv. Gaming Regulations, 2025.
- v. Diaspora Birth Rights Certificate Bill, 2025.
- v. Community Service Bill, 2025.
- vi. Extradition Bill, 2025.

The Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources will want us to ratify a number of mining leases. These will include:

- i. Ratification of Mining Leases in respect of Perseus Mining Ghana Limited; Clean Jobs Ghana Limited; TMC Limited; GM Group of Companies Limited; Golden Star (Wassa) Limited; Zogok Gold Limited; Gadriator Group of Companies Limited; Maripoma Mining Services Limited; and Bariri DV Ghana Limited.

They also plan to bring before us the Wildlife Resources Management Regulations, 2025.

Mr Speaker, let me at this juncture mention that whilst we were away on recess, the issue is illegal mining, otherwise referred to as “*galamsey*”, became topical. His Excellency President John Mahama spoke to the Nation in a media interaction and outlined progress made so far and the multiple approaches of the Government.

During this Meeting, this House will build the needed collaboration and coalition of MPs to join the fight against *galamsey*. After all, it is happening in our various constituencies and by our own constituents. We, perhaps, hold the key to solving this problem. In this regard, we will demand full accountability of the Minerals Commission and the Environmental Protection Agency in the way mining prospecting licenses are awarded and leases issued and the environmental implications.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs has some international agreements which we will be called upon to consider for ratification. Some are:

- i. Visa Waiver Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana and the Republic of Algeria, the Republic of Angola and the Republic of Serbia.

- ii. Headquarters Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana and Afrobarometer.
- iii. Presidential Initiative to offer 1,000 Tertiary Scholarships to ECOWAS Citizens.
- iv. Waiver of Import Duties and other Taxes on Vehicles for Foreign Service Officers and Analogous Appointees.
- v. Establishment and Implementation of Ghana Diaspora Bond Programme.
- vi. Membership in the Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa (BRICS) Alliance.

Let me mention that the issue of the need for parliamentary ratification of the agreement with the United States to receive ECOWAS citizens being repatriated back to the sub-region has been widely debated. If the appropriate legal advice to this House is that we should ratify it, we will so consider. But I can say with authority that the Majority approves of the arrangement and highly commends the Government for negotiating the removal of the US visa restrictions on Ghanaians. Given our business and social ties with America, these restrictions were going to be extremely burdensome to many Ghanaian businesses.

The Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs will seek the passage of:

- i. Local Governance (Amendment) Bill, 2025.
- ii. Coastal Development Authority (Repeal) Bill, 2025.
- iii. Middle Belt Development Authority (Repeal) Bill, 2025.

The programme of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition includes the ratification and passage of:

- i. National Petroleum Authority Bill, 2025.
- ii. Ratification of Petroleum Agreement in respect of Block GH_WB_01
- iii. involving the Government of Ghana, GNPC, GNPC Explorco and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited.
- iv. Nuclear Power Corporation Bill, 2025.
- v. Renewable Energy Authority Bill, 2025.
- vi. Establishment of the Ghana Energy Regulatory Commission

- vii. West African Gas Pipeline (Amendment) Regulations, 2025.

The Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection will seek the passage of the:

- i. The Affirmative Action (Gender Equity) Regulations, 2025.
- ii. The Social Protection Regulations, 2025.

The Office of the Attorney-General and the Ministry of Justice have a tall legislative programme. They include:

- i. Tribunals Bill, 2025.
- ii. Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025.
- iii. Conduct of Public Office Bill, 2025.
- iv. Economic and Organised Crime (Amendment) Bill, 2025.
- v. Ghana Intellectual Property Office Bill, 2025.
- vi. Interstate Succession Bill, 2025.
- vii. Legal Profession Bill, 2025.
- viii. Notaries Public (Amendment) Bill, 2025.

- ix. State Property and Contracts (Amendment) Bill, 2025.

- x. Court of Appeal Rules, 2025.

- xi. Economic and Organised Crime Office (Operations) Regulations, 2025.

- xii. Economic and Organised Crime Office (Terms and Conditions of Service) Regulations, 2025.

- xiii. High Court (Civil Procedure) (Amendment) Rules, 2025.

- xiv. Interpretation Regulations, 2025.

- xv. Legal Aid Commission Regulations, 2025.

The Ministry of Sports and Recreation will bring the following for consideration:

- i. Sports Fund Bill, 2025.
- ii. Sports Fund Regulations, 2025.
- iii. National Sports College Bill, 2025.
- iv. Anti-Doping Regulations, 2025.

The Ministry of Defence plans to have us consider the National Defence

University Bill, 2025 and the Defence Industrial Development Cooperation Bill, 2025.

I cannot list the entire legislative programme. It promises to be weighty. I, therefore, urge Colleagues to dedicate time and energy to the task ahead of us in this Meeting.

I must mention that once again, we will have an opportunity to vet the nominee for the position of the new Chief Justice of Ghana. It shall definitely be a momentous occasion. Need I say that the nominee should prepare to earn the approval of this House.

Mr Speaker, to ensure greater efficiency, I have engaged with Colleague Leadership of the minuscule Minority, and we have agreed that this Meeting, we will always schedule Government Business before personal Business. That way, we will ensure that Members of Parliament (MPs) come on time, we transact Government Business first, and then afterwards, we move to individual Statements and MPs Questions to Ministers. We believe that this will even be convenient for MPs, given the fact that we now have our own television channel and enjoy live coverage.

This Parliament has many new Members. I urge them not to stop learning. Please sit in the House, observe and learn. They should build their capacity to participate effectively. They can only learn by practice.

Mr Speaker, as usual, we count on your continued guidance. You know it all, and under your guidance, we cannot go astray. Let me congratulate you on Ghana's Parliament once again being adjudged the Most Open Parliament in Africa by the Africa Open Parliament Index (OPI). This is the second time our Parliament has won this coveted award, having won it in 2022.

All this bears testament to your remarkable leadership and foresight in managing this noble institution, congratulations Mr Speaker.

Hon Colleagues, I welcome you back to this House for the Third Meeting of the First Session of the Ninth Parliament. May the Almighty God direct our every step, and may the work we will do together in this Meeting, make Ghana great and strong.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.
[Hear! Hear!]

4:09

The Speaker: Hon Members, I am sure you have observed a facelift in the Chamber that you are now occupying. You can see there is a facelift, and I want to thank the Clerk and our supporting staff for implementing this decision of the Board. You would have also observed that just behind me, our traditional attire, our own hand-woven cloths, are distinguished and you could

see that there has also been a renewal of those majestic cloths. [*Hear! Hear!*] I think you may have read that I led a delegation including the Second Deputy Speaker and some members of staff to extend our condolences to the King of Ashanti, Otumfuo Nana Osei Tutu II, on the loss of our mother, the Queen Mother. You would have read that we did make a request because this was the gracious presentation of His Majesty the King when Parliament started in January 1993. They had lost some favour and so we appealed to him if he could graciously come and renew them, and he immediately accepted and directed that it be done. The next day, to our surprise, the team was down here in Accra, and you can see a complete fresh renewal of those majestic cultural displays of our talents. [*Hear! Hear!*]

I would want to take this opportunity to appreciate the efforts and the gracious support of H.E. Otumfuo Nana Osei Tutu II. He has done tremendously well and he will continue to be the father of all. We know his passion for multi-party democracy. He has been a guide to all of us, particularly somebody like me as a Speaker of the Eighth and the Ninth Parliaments of the Fourth Republic of Ghana.

Hon Members, I want to draw your attention to the names and meaning of what we have behind me. I am very challenged and so, if my pronunciation

offends your ears, kindly forgive me because I am of a different ethnic group. These *kente* cloths are of two types. One is called *Edwene si dwene so*. This is a type of high quality hand-woven Ghanaian *kente* cloth that translates to ‘designs upon designs’ or ‘wisdom upon wisdom’. The second is called *Fathia fata Nkrumah*. That definitely is clear to all of you, even including me. It is a Ghanaian *kente* cloth pattern whose name translates to Fathia is a fitting wife for Nkrumah. In fact, those of us who are old enough used to hear it. It was created to honour the marriage of Ghana’s first President; in fact, we should always start by saying first Prime Minister and first President, Dr Kwame Nkrumah and his Egyptian wife Fathia Nkrumah. This symbolises the unity of Africa and the Arab world. In fact, that was one of the visible steps that Nkrumah took to try to unite the States in Africa by personally moving beyond the shores of Ghana to marry from Egypt.

Hon Members, I think you will assist me, as I said, to thank His Royal Majesty for his gracious support to the House. I will on your behalf send a fitting thank you message to His Excellency. But let me add that the Second Deputy Speaker has been so helpful in these matters. In fact, he has led me a number of times to pay homage to H.E. the King of Asante. We have always had very fruitful discussions, and he has always been a source of strength and wisdom to some

of us. Please kindly accept my thanks, my Colleague and good Brother, the Second Deputy Speaker for what you are doing for us.

With this, I would want to invite the First Deputy Speaker to take the Chair while I prepare for another assignment this evening. In the meantime, we would move on to the next item which is the routine business of correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

The Speaker: Hon Members, we will start with the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 1st August, 2025.

Page 1...4?

First Deputy Speaker to take the Chair.

[4:20 p.m. — Hon First Deputy Speaker, Mr Bernard Ahiafor in the Chair]

4:19 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 5...14?

Page 14...20—

Yes, Hon Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I stood up when you got to page 16. Page 16 “Opening”, item numbered 1 (ii) and

(iii) I would like you to check “Akyem”, I think it is supposed to be A-K-I-M, so let us cross-check and get the right name. It is “West Akim” A-K-I-M and (iii) should be A-K-I-M. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, thank you very much. Table Office, check the spelling, whether it is “Akyem” or “Akim”.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, also on page numbered 19, under the item numbered 1 “Opening”, “The Committee met on Wednesday, 23rd July 2025 at 2.15 a.m.”. It is supposed to be “p.m.” and not “a.m.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table Office, take note.

Page 21...27—

Yes, Hon Member?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, on page 27, item numbered 3 (vi), “Mr Christian Addai-Poku” the Registrar of the National Teaching Council is a doctor. This is a minor correction. He is “Dr Christian Addai-Poku”, not “Mr”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, take note. Thank you very much, Hon Member for Kwadaso. Page 28...30.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 1st August, 2025 as corrected is hereby adopted as the true records of proceedings.

Hon Members, we have the *Official Reports* of 28th July, 2025 and 29th July, 2025. Let us consider that of 28th July first. It is for your corrections.

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Monday, 28th July, 2025]

Now, the *Official Report* of 29th July, 2025 is under correction. Yes, Hon Member for Kwadaso?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, on column 17, the second paragraph, last sentence is about the name of “Mohamed Polo”. “Mohammed” is spelt “M-O-H-A-M-E-D” but it should be double “m”. So, if Office of Chamber Reporting can check, if it is double M, then they make the necessary changes.

Then we come to column 179 under “Rev John Ntim Fordjour”, there is an omission. If we look at the fourth line, “that this House approves the Mid-Year Review the Budget...” “of” has to be inserted so that it reads “that this House approves the Mid-Year Review of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana”. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Member. Office of Chamber Reporting, kindly take note.

Hon Members, in the absence of any further correction, the *Official Report* of 29th July, 2025, as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

We move to the item numbered 8, Business Statement for the first week. Chairman of the Business Committee and the Majority Leader?

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Chairman of the Committee and Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, the Committee met yesterday, Monday, 20th October, 2025, and arranged Business of the House for the First Week ending Friday, 24th October, 2025. Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its report as follows:

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policy. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Standing Order 93 of Parliament.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Standing Order 159 of Parliament, Bills may be presented to the House for First Reading. However, those of urgent

nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Standing Order 160 of Parliament.

Pursuant to Standing Order 97 of Parliament, Papers may be laid during the week and Reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the week. Mr Speaker, the Business Committee takes the opportunity to welcome all Hon Members back from the recess.

The Third Meeting is expected to be demanding of Hon Members in view of the fact that a significant part of the Meeting will be devoted to the consideration of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government for 2026 together with the Budget Estimates of Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs). The House would also consider other Businesses requiring the consideration of Parliament including financial Bills before adjournment *sine die* for the Yuletide.

Hon Members are, therefore, entreated to brace themselves up for the task ahead.

Time to Commence Sittings of the House

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee discussed the issue of the time for the

commencement of Sitting of the House and the Business Committee takes notice that the introduction of the commencement of Sittings at 2:00 p.m. with the aim of improving Members' participation in the conduct of parliamentary Business has not been very successful and we must all admit it.

Additionally, commencing Sittings at 2:00 p.m. mostly resulted in the late adjournment of the House. The attention of the Business Committee has been drawn to the health and security risk this poses to Hon Members, Staff and Visitors of the House, including students who commute long distances to observe proceedings. In view of this, the Business Committee proposes that the House reverts to commencing Sittings at 10:00 a.m. subject to review when needed.

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216(2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the business of the House shall be taken during the week.

4.29 p.m.

Tuesday, 21st October, 2025

Roll Call

Oaths

National Pledge

Statements

Presentation of Papers—

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Public Interest and Accountability Committee (PIAC) for the year 2024.
- (b) Annual Report of the Public Interest and Accountability Committee (PIAC) on the Management and Use of Petroleum Revenues for the Period January – December 2024.
- (c) Report of the National Population Council Secretariat on the Fifty-Eighth Session of the Commission on Population and Development (CPD) held in April 2025 in New York.

Presentation and First Reading of Bills

- Property Rights of Spouses Bill, 2025.
- Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Bill, 2025.

Motions

Committee sittings

Wednesday, 22nd October, 2025

Statements

Presentation of Petitions

- Petition of the Onion Drivers and Transporters Association that Parliament investigates the alleged wrongful collection of spot fines from onion drivers and transporters at Axle Weighing Stations because their vehicles exceed the required length; directs the suspension of the collection of the spot fines from Onion Drivers and Transporters and be given some time to trim their vehicles.

Presentation of Papers—

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Teresa's College of Education for the year 2024.
- (b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Al-Faruq College of Education for the year 2024.

(c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tamale Technical University for the year 2024.

(d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. John Bosco's College of Education, Navrongo for the year 2024.

(e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Commission for Human Right and Administration Justice for the year 2024.

(f) Report of the Ad Hoc Committee to consider the establishment of a Pension Scheme for Members of Parliament.

Motion—

(a) That this honourable House constitutes an Ad Hoc Committee to recommend for appointment by Parliament an Auditor to audit and report on the Financial Statements of the Office of the Auditor-General for the year ended 31st December, 2024.

Committee sittings

Thursday, 23rd October, 2025

Statements

Presentation of Papers—

(a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Awutu Senya District Assembly for the year 2024.

(b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Offinso Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(c) Risk-Based Internal Audit Work Plan of the Internal Audit Unit Offinso Municipal Assembly for the period 1st April to 31st December, 2025.

(d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bodi District Assembly for the year 2024.

(e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Volta Regional Coordinating Council for the year 2024.

(f) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Weija-Gbawe Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

- (g) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Wassa Amenfi East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (h) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kassena Nankana West District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sekyere Kumawu District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (j) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nkwanta South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (k) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Savannah Regional Co-ordinating Council for the year 2024.
- (l) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga Central Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (m) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Techiman North District

Assembly for the year 2024.

- (n) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bia West District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (o) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asante Akim South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (p) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the North Dayi District Assembly for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee sittings

Friday, 24th October, 2025

Statements

Presentation of Papers—

- (a) Semi-Annual Report on the Ghana Petroleum Funds for the period 1st January to 30th June, 2025.
- (b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the

Tema Oil Refinery for the year 2024.

- (c) Report on the Conduct of Monetary Policy, Macroeconomic Review and Banking Sector Development for the period January to June, 2025.
- (d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Minerals Income Investment Fund for the year 2024.
- (e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cocoa Processing Company PLC for the year 2024.
- (f) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Insurance Commission for the year 2024.
- (g) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Export – Import Bank for the year 2024.
- (h) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Infrastructure Investment Fund for the year 2024

Motions

Committee sittings

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Business Statement duly presented by the Chairman of the Business Committee and the Leader of the House. It is now for your comment.

Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I would like to highly commend the Business Committee for this Business Statement for the week. In particular, regarding the reversal of our commencement of sitting from 2:00 p.m. to 10:00 a.m. I think it is commendable because of the health implications that our Leader cleverly alluded to. I would like to also suggest that we need to pay fidelity to the time. Mr Speaker, with respect, when it is 10:00 a.m., it should be 10:00 a.m. Sometimes when it is 10:00a.m., you will come to the Chamber, and Sitting starts at 11:00 a.m. or 12:00 noon, and I do not think that it is fair.

So, if we are going back to 10:00 a.m., we might be punctual regarding the time. If the 10:00 a.m. is going to be difficult, then in between 10:00 a.m. and 2:00 p.m., 12 noon should be also considered. But I prefer the 10:00 a.m. and I am hoping that we should be able to stick with the time.

Mr Speaker, if you look at Order 12(4),

“Whenever the Speaker, the First Deputy Speaker and the Second Deputy Speaker are unavoidably absent, the Clerk shall chair the

Sitting for the election of a Member to preside at that Sitting of the House as ‘the Member Presiding’.”

I think one of these Orders talks about where a Member can be elected to sit in the Chair. So, I am saying that if, Mr Speaker, your good self, or the Second Deputy Speaker are not there, we should be able to elect somebody to sit in the Chair for us to respect the time. This is all that I am asking for.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you suggesting that the delay is as a result of the Speaker, the First Deputy and the Second Deputy not being available?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I cannot with any stretch of imagination suggest that. I am not saying that. I am saying that for us to start business, somebody must be in the Chair. If there is nobody in the Chair, Business for the day cannot start. So, if we are two, three or four and nobody raises a matter of quorum, Sitting can start. I think that it is the Speakers who can help us to respect the new time set to 10:00 a.m. This is what I am asking for, and thanks for indulging me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, but let me also place on record that mostly we are here, but Members are not available.

Prof Nyarko: You are right. I cannot dispute that.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Alhaji Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I would like to find out from the Chairman of the Business Committee. Mr Speaker had admitted my Motion of review on the form in which the Budget will be presented to the House. As we are aware, the first Budget Statement of the Minister for Finance, was in the form of a Statement, and I raised issues concerning the form in which it was presented.

Subsequently, for the Mid-Year Budget, he came through a Motion. So, it is not captured on the Business Statement, and I think that this is very important considering the fact that this is a budget —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Look at the item numbered 2(d) on the Business Statement.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, 2(d), the Speaker’s Motion may be debated, and there are some special resolutions if taken. I do not know, because there are a couple of Motions that I know that the able —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so it means that the Motions that are going to be taken within the week are not listed here. So, by the application of *ejusdem generis*, if yours is a Motion, it can be

taken under this item. Do you not agree with me?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am guided, and if that is the case, I will rest that matter for now. The second point is that the reason the Business Committee is giving us, based on the change of time of sitting, I think is a bit problematic. There were reasons we said we should sit at 2:00 p.m., and among many others was the fact that we have Ministers and Deputy Ministers and other people who have Government engagement, so that from morning until 2:00 p.m., they will be able to do their official work, and then they can attend to the House by 2:00 p.m. If it is the case that we want to change it to 9:00 a.m., I do not think it will cure the problem that we identified early on.

Our Standing Orders have made it clear that, normally sitting should be five hours, and if we are going to sit more than five hours, then the Speaker can give that directive. So, if we can manage our time based on the Business that the Majority has, and they can prioritise the Business that they are able to do, the timing will not be a problem.

I still think that the reason the Chairman of the Business Committee had given is something that will not stand the test of time because like Prof Nyarko rightly said, if we do not start exactly at 10:00 a.m., we will definitely run into the evening, and we in the Minority will not take excuses from the Chairman of the Business Committee, the Majority

Leader, that we are starting at 10:00 a.m. because his Ministers are not here, they are in the Ministry, his Deputy Ministers are not here, they are in the Ministry attending to Government work and other things that we have made provisions for. If we are starting at 10:00 a.m. and we agree, we will not take excuses as to why Ministers are not in the Chamber to attend to either Questions or Business.

So, I think we need to look at it properly, and if it is the case that it is always going to be 10:00 a.m., or if we are to vary it based on the kind of work that we have in the Chamber, then we will be guided by that. But I think that the change of time will not cure any problem. It would rather cause problem for you, Majority Leader, because many of your Ministers might not be in the Chamber by then. By 2 o'clock, we could see that many of them do attend when we give them the 2 o'clock time. I think that we should look at it properly.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes? You have the floor.

Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth: Mr Speaker, I also want to commend the Business Committee for putting out this Statement, except that I observed that there were no Questions programmed for the week. I remember that I had three Questions for the Minister for Roads and Highways bordering on some very urgent roads that were ongoing but are

stalled in Dewu, Abonse-Aseseeso, and Asaase Kokoo areas. Looking at our place, it has begun raining, and this is the time that we have our festivals. But I could see that there were no Questions programmed. This has already been filed so if the Business Committee could look at it.

Mr Speaker, again, I want to commend you and the staff and the management team for this beautiful work done. However, if you go to our offices, you can see that especially on the 11th, 8th floor west area, a lot of the air conditioners are not working. So, I thought that while this good work had been done here, we could have extended it to the offices before coming.

Mr Speaker, these are a few things that I want the Business Committee to note.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

4:39 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the issue of Ministers making themselves available will be addressed once Ministers are certain that when they come to the House at 10:00 a.m., Government Business will shortly be taken. Very often, a Minister has business, he or she comes to the House and then we start with Statements. A Minister will not know exactly when the Statements will be over because it

will be subject to the contributions that Members may make and the discretion of the Speaker. And then with Question time, we start a Question, then ask follow up questions and some Ministers also provide very lengthy Answers. So, when we have Government Business, Ministers cannot really plan. They can come and then spend the whole day here.

So very often, they decide to sit in their offices for us to call them over when we are ready. So, the discussion at Business Committee was to create certainty so that Ministers know that when we start Sitting, the first item will be Government Business, so that Business will be dealt with and then they can go and we can remain to take our personal Business. If the personal Business has to do with that Minister, then the Minister has to stay because Members asking Questions are personal Businesses. But if the Question is asked to a Minister, the Minister has to be here to answer that Question, so the Minister must be here. Statements are personal Businesses.

But when we have Bills, agreements and loan transactions to approve among others, those are Government Business and in those cases, we often have to vote. And the MPs also complain that when they come, so many Questions are being asked as well as follow-up questions and then Statements are being made. And if the person really has no interest in the Question or even the content of the Statement, they have to sit through and never know exactly when Government Business will be taken so that their votes

will be required. So very often, they step out and then they never come back or they decide to go to sit in their offices and watch us on television, only to come when it is time for Government Business and their votes are needed. But let us not also forget that because we were sitting in the afternoons, very often by 10:00 p.m. or 11:00 p.m., we were still in this Chamber. Sometimes we left at midnight. I am not saying that when we used to start at 10:00 a.m., we never closed at midnight. But those were rare occasions towards the end of proceedings. But when we started sitting at 2:00 p.m., it became constant and habitual that we will leave here after 10:00 p.m.

And most people's private routines do not start in the afternoon. Whether Parliament is starting at 10:00 a.m. or 2:00 p.m., people will have to send children to school early in the morning, so they will wake up early in the morning anyway. Yet, they will also come to Parliament and sit and close at 10:00 p.m. to 12 midnight. So, it was beginning to really take a toll on the health of Members and it was even difficult to keep them in the Chamber.

So, at the Business Committee, we considered all that and decided that we should revert to the 10:00 a.m. meetings. With the issue of questions being programmed for the week, I think the practise is that Questions are not programmed in the first week. So subsequent weeks, Questions will be programmed. With the air conditioners,

yes, we have taken note of them and I think that there are procurement issues that are being addressed. I have been briefed by the Chief Whip and the Clerk, so they are expediting the procurement processes so that they can fix the air conditioners. Also, some of the lifts are not working well. In fact, all of them were down, but just before the resumption, some were fixed. Others are still being fixed and the Speaker has briefed me that indeed, there is a programme to replace the lifts because the pressure on the lifts is too much so we need stronger lifts. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I want to thank the Leader of the House for taking us through the Business Committee's report for the ensuing week. There are some few observations I want to put across.

One, on the listed Business of Members: Questions and Motions. Mr Speaker, we have a backlog of Questions. I would plead with the Leader of Government Business to work closely with the Clerks-at-the-Table to programme the Ministers to come. And to our dear Ministers, they should prioritise Parliament because some of the last-minute excuses affect Members. So, Mr Speaker, if we are not going to have them this week, I would plead that the necessary correspondents should get to

their desks for them to start coming to answer Questions next week.

Then, Mr Speaker, on Motions, we have this important Motion that I moved. It was seconded and debate commenced. It took us over seven weeks; we could not take the Motion on the mass dismissal. The need for Parliament to invite the Chief of Staff to provide guidance— *[Interruption]*. Yes, that is the Motion. It is a matter of record. Because the burden of that Motion really is whether or not the Chief of Staff can, by an administrative directive, instruct Chief Executives of state-owned institutions to terminate contracts of their employees. They are not part of the mainstream public service. The fact that the state has majority shares in an enterprise does not give unfettered powers to Government, to, as it were, direct termination of employment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, respectfully, is your concern not addressed by the item numbered 2(d)? My view is that it is here, that Motions and Resolutions: “Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential resolutions, if any, taken during the week.” And it is the Order Paper that will specify the Motions that are supposed to be taken. So, for the purposes of the Business Statement, it has been captured.

4:49 p.m.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the

guidance. We always learn at your feet. The mainstay of my submission really is the fact that this is general. I am only appealing to the Leader of Government Business to ensure that we do not just make general provisions, but then we should ensure that the item or the subject matter appears on the Order Paper. That is the burden of my call. So, I agree with you on that score. I am taking the opportunity to further reiterate the fact that these are human rights issues. Many Ghanaian youth who were employed two or three years—The petitions are all before us. And because of that omnibus directive, Ghana Maritime Authority, Ghana Road Fund Secretariat, Ghana Revenue Authority, Ghana Gas—Mr Speaker, all these employees were sacked. The only place guaranteed by the Constitution for their views and concerns to be heard is the people’s Chamber, Parliament. Yes, the court is there, but where the people’s representative would have to speak for them—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, under the Rules, it appears you are arguing your Motion.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well, Mr Speaker, I will rest my case. I just needed to bring that to the attention of the House.

Mr Speaker, my last point is that the Hon Majority Leader, in his opening remarks underscored an important point that the one who has been nominated for the Chief Justice position must come prepared to earn the approval of the

House. *[Interruption]*—No, I am—Because it is a programme. He says he should come prepared. I am not speaking in respect of that matter specifically, but all nominees who will be appearing before us should take a cue from the Hon Majority Leader. If they come unprepared, they do not have their judgements; we have questions about their involvement in the sacking of their boss. We have concerns about how they have behaved and all. They must answer. They have to prepare. I agree with the call by the Hon Majority Leader that the person must come prepared. That is his call. So, I am just drawing his attention that it is not enough. But they should know—Because we would not sit idly by. Already there are constitutional issues as to whether with the former Chief Justice Torkornoo being in court, another person can be nominated. It is a matter of constitutional concern, but Mr Speaker, this is not the time for it. The time will come for a full debate on this.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, it is now time for you to comment on the Business Statement.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well, Mr Speaker, I will rest my case. I was just drawing your attention—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Yes, Chairman of the Business Committee.

Mr Ayariga: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I just want to assure the Hon Minority Leader that we will make sure that when Questions are asked, Ministers are notified and they appear in the House to answer those Questions. On the issues of the pending Motions and the dismissals of some employees of some state institutions or state-owned agencies, I also want to draw the attention of the Hon Minority Leader to a recent video clip of his at a campaign rally where he was boasting of how whilst in office, as an NPP Government, they used their office to improperly recruit people into all sorts of agencies, including the security agencies. He clearly indicated that the NPP in government abused its office, appointees abused their office and they recruited without going through the proper recruitment channels, and filled vacancies with party faithfuls. They were daring the NDC to see if the NDC would also be able to fill those public offices with their party faithfuls—**[An Hon Member:** Leader, *bɔ hɔ bio*].

By those statements, he had justified the decision to dismiss those people. He had authenticated the claim that whilst in office, they improperly, unconstitutionally, illegally and inconsistent with constitutional requirements, recruited people and placed them in offices when they should not have done so. So, he cannot be making those statements at rallies and then come to this Chamber and say that we should investigate those recruitments and the dismissals. If he wants us to carry out an enquiry, we will be enquiring and investigating his statement because he is

actually admitting to crimes. He was publicly admitting the commission of crimes in relation to recruitment, especially to security agencies, and he comes to this Chamber to say we should investigate the removal of some people from offices. It will not happen here, and it will never happen. *[Interruption]* It will not happen because he has actually justified the decisions—**[An Hon Member:** Have mercy on him]—He has justified the decisions.

What he said at the rally is a very serious matter coming from the Opposition Leader. Other people are actually calling on us in the NDC to probe all the recruitments that took place because he has publicly indicated that while in office, they used their office to stuff public agencies with party faithfuls. How do you do that? And they are trying to create problems for the NDC Administration and trying to trap us to behave like their Government. We will not behave like them. **[Some Hon Members:** No, no, no]—We will not behave like them because Ghanaians rejected them overwhelmingly for behaving that way. We do not want to be rejected by Ghanaians, so we will not follow their footsteps. We will not be enticed by his statements. He should be apologising to Ghanaians for what he did.

Mr Speaker, on the issue of vetting, yes, I stated that and I meant it. This Side of the House, even though we have an overwhelming majority and can approve anybody nominated by the President

who is at the presidency on our ticket, we are serving notice that we are committed to doing a diligent job. So anybody appearing before this House will be properly scrutinised and the person should earn their nomination and the approval of this House. So that, we are committed to.

Mr Speaker, I thank you very much. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, is it about the Business Statement?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Hon Majority Leader at the despatch box made some statements that have gone into the *Hansard* and since I am right here, it is important to set the record straight and put the appropriate facts out.

Mr Speaker, it is a fact that upon the assumption of office of the NDC, I did say that the many youths who supported them should expect to be employed. It is a fact, I said so. I also said—*[Interruption]*—No, I have not spoken on these things two weeks ago. I spoke in January and I said that during NPP's time, the youth of our country were employed. I would want the Hon Majority Leader to bring the speech. What the people expect is to give them jobs. You the Majority, you promise them one job, three shifts. So, if you come here and say that, oh, I was talking about matters that involve criminality, I think perhaps you did not pay attention

to the tape. Unless you did, but you want to spin it, which on this occasion I believe you meant to spin and you were spinning.

Mr Speaker, the issue of mass dismissal is of great concern to all of us. So, Hon Majority Leader, please, deal with it. But if you now say that, I said some people were employed under NDC, even if they were NPP, are they not Ghanaians? If you are going to investigate people who have been recruited in a particular era and you want to do it, go and investigate and sack all of them.

4:59 p.m.

If that is what they want to do, they should go and do it; nobody stops them. If they want to sack them, they should sack them; we do not have a problem. I have not made the statement in the context that he described for *Hansard*, and he knows that; he is a lawyer, and he knows that. He was being a spin doctor on that. What they should be concerned about is the many youths from their various constituencies, 188 plus. Their people are asking, where are the jobs? The people want you to get them jobs. The MPs in this Chamber have pressure on them, the Majority side. They bring their CVs to them, especially the MPs without portfolios. There is so much pressure on them, so Mr Speaker, I think we should focus on the issue, rather than trivialising it. I rest my case.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Yes, Chief Whip?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the matter before us is a subject of Order 71, and the protocol is that when the Business Statement is presented, and a Member raises matters arising out of the Business Statement, the Chairman of the Business Committee would respond. But, Mr Speaker, what the Minority Leader is doing is neither a Question nor a supplementary Question to the answers my Leader has provided. He is just going to town.

So, Mr Speaker, I seek your guidance in this matter. If he wants to ask a question, he should do so, then my Leader will respond. He should frame his questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think I need not give any guidance in this matter. We are all clear as to what we should do when the Business Statement is presented, but sometimes some Members go overboard.

Hon Members, subject to further deliberations on the time of commencement of sitting, hoping that Leadership would engage, the Business Statement is hereby adopted.

Hon Members, I understand the Statement has not been uploaded, so maybe we will take it tomorrow.

Yes, Majority Leader, any indication?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we can take item numbered 10. We can just lay the Reports, and then we can take an adjournment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: At the commencement of Public Business, presentation of Papers.

PAPERS

By the Majority Leader —

- i. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Public Interest and Accountability Committee (PIAC) for the year 2024.
- ii. Annual Report of the Public Interest and Accountability Committee (PIAC) on the Management and Use of Petroleum Revenues for the Period January – December 2024.

Referred to the Finance Committee.

By the Majority Leader —

Report of the National Population Council Secretariat on the Fifty-Eighth Session of the Commission on Population and Development (CPD)

held in April 2025 in New York.

Referred to the Committee on Economy and Development.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I move for an adjournment.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I second the Motion, except that I want to draw the Majority Leader's attention to when he was delivering his speech; he said the Majority is overwhelming. But they are less than 30 in the Chamber. Too many empty seats. Today, there is no Government Business and their Members are not in the Chamber. They have 189. The trust the Ghanaian people gave to them is not to give us an empty Chamber. So please, Mr Speaker, I second the Motion because they are not prepared for today's Business so we can adjourn.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader. In the circumstances, we adjourn to 10 o'clock or 2 o'clock. You see, the Business Statement is adopted subject to further deliberation. So the *status quo* must remain until the conclusion of the deliberation.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, for the record, are we coming back 2 p.m. tomorrow, God willing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will say
so.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

*The House was accordingly adjourned
till Wednesday, 22nd October, 2025 at 2
o'clock in the afternoon.*

Editor's Note

This *Official Report* was corrected by the House on 29th October, 2025 as follows:

- (a) Column 36, paragraph 1, line 1, “and” was inserted after “Science” and “and Innovation” was deleted after “Technology”.
- (b) Column 43, paragraph 3, line 7, “Agency” was replaced with “Authority”
- (c) Column 59, item numbered ii. “Training and Entrepreneurial Development” was added to “Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills”
- (d) Page vii, under M, “Esq” after “Tiah” was deleted.

